

CITY: PG 3

Hotel robe widens, cook held

NATION: PG 5

Punjab: 9 killed after pick-up vehicle collides with truck

FILM: PG 12

Before it sat on millions of wrists, it was just an idea

CHAIRS EAC MEETING

PM maps growth amid turmoil

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday discussed with the members of the Economic Advisory Council various measures to further boost India's economic growth amid global turmoil.

The members of the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (EAC-PM) also gave their assessment of the impact of the West Asia conflict on India and the world.

"Chaired a meeting of the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister. Deliberated on a wide range of issues relating to India's economic transformation and long-term development priorities.

"Also shared perspectives on adding more momentum to the reforms journey and ensuring 'Ease of Living' as well as 'Ease of Doing Business,'" PM Modi said in a post on 'X'.

The Prime Minister and the EAC members discussed various



Prime Minister Narendra Modi chairs a meeting with members of the PM-Economic Advisory Council, in New Delhi, on Saturday

ideas and measures to further boost India's economic growth in times of global turmoil, sources said. Various reforms to improve ease of living and ease of doing business were also discussed at

the high-level meeting, they said. The EAC is an independent body that gives advice to the Government of India, specifically to the Prime Minister, on economic and related issues.

Two principal secretaries to the Prime Minister -- PK Mishra and Shaktikanta Das -- attended the meeting, besides the members of the EAC.

At present, the EAC comprises the chairman, three full-time members and 11 part-time members. S Mahendra Dev is the chairman, while full-time members are Sanjay Kumar Mishra, Sanjeev Sanyal and Shamika Ravi.

At UN forum, firm message

UNITED NATIONS: India has slammed Pakistan for its "unwarranted reference" to Jammu and Kashmir at the UN, telling the current non-permanent member of the global body that it was a huge responsibility and not a forum for peddling "biased and false narratives".

"The unwarranted reference by Pakistan to a matter strictly internal to India, the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir, has compelled me to respond," India's Permanent Representative to the UN Ambassador Parvathaneni Harish said on Friday.

IRAN, US EXCHANGE CEASEFIRE VIOLATION CHARGES

Gulf tensions flare again after strikes



A Lebanese army soldier removes the rubble of a house that was destroyed in the recent clashes between Hezbollah fighters and Israeli troops in, southeast Lebanon

ASSOCIATED PRESS

CAIRO: Iran fired ballistic missiles and drones toward Bahrain and Kuwait early Saturday, Bahrain's government said, adding that they were intercepted. It called on Tehran to immediately cease attacks on Gulf neighbours that it deemed a "serious escalation."

Iran's foreign ministry said the US early Saturday attacked surveillance facilities on Qeshm Island and near Sirik that it said were used to protect borders and "ensure the security of navigation in international waters." Tehran called the attack a violation of the fragile ceasefire.

The latest exchange of fire came as the Trump administration pressed Iran to make a deal to end the war that has strained the global economy and threatened a hunger crisis in some of the world's most vulnerable countries.

Iran said it targeted the US military.

The US military earlier said it shot down several Iranian missiles and drones launched toward the Strait of Hormuz and Gulf Arab allies, and struck some of the Islamic Republic's coastal surveillance radar sites in response.

"The attack drones posed an immediate threat to regional maritime traffic,"

Ceasefire tested as Israeli strikes kill 9

BEIRUT: Israeli airstrikes on southern Lebanon on Saturday killed nine people, including three members of the Lebanese military, the Lebanese army and state media said, days after the two sides reached a new ceasefire deal.

An airstrike on a vehicle on a road linking the city of Nabatiyah with the town of Marjayoun killed a brigadier general, a captain and another soldier, the army said, without immediately releasing their names. Another airstrike on the southern village of Saksakiyah killed six people and wounded four, the state-run National News Agency said.

Adani's richest comeback

NEW DELHI: Adani Group Chairman Gautam Adani has once again become Asia's richest person after a strong rally in Adani Group stocks lifted his net worth above those of Reliance Industries Chairman Mukesh Ambani and SoftBank Group CEO Masayoshi Son.

According to Forbes' real-time billionaire rankings, Adani's fortune has risen to \$89.2 billion, surpassing Ambani's \$88 billion and Son's \$87 billion. Son had briefly held the top spot in Asia before a decline in SoftBank shares on Thursday reduced his wealth.

The resurgence in Adani's fortune has been driven by a sharp rise in the group's listed companies. On Friday, Adani Green Energy shares surged nearly 7 per cent, while Adani Energy Solutions gained around 4 per cent. Adani Enterprises Ltd and Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone advanced about 2 per cent each, while Adani Power rose more than 1 per cent. Adani Group stocks have gained between 23 per cent and 56 per cent so far in 2026.



Sanctions on India will boomerang, says Putin

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

ST PETERSBURG: Russian President Vladimir Putin has said that any attempt to undermine India's sovereignty through "threats of sanctions" would "boomerang immediately" under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership.

Putin made these remarks at the annual St Petersburg International Economic Forum on Friday in response to a question about his comments during an interaction with heads of leading global news agencies, including PTI, on Thursday night.

"India always acts as a sovereign country, and under the leadership of Prime Minister Modi, any potential threats of sanctions would boomerang immediately," Putin said.

Putin said that he has been in close talks with Prime Minister Modi for a long period, while recalling the time when the Indian leader was banned from entering the United States.

"I know PM Modi will never forget about it," Putin said. "Now that he is (the) prime minister, all the sanctions have been eliminated, and the relationship between the US and India is developing successfully as far as I understand."

Asked about the possibility of India facing US sanctions if it were to acquire Russian defence systems such as the Su-57 aircraft or the S-500 air defence platform, Putin said, "India is a sovereign country, and it is free to choose those products that they consider to be most up to date and most applicable for them and obviously offering the best price."

KEY POINTS

- » 'India always acts as a sovereign country, and under the leadership of Prime Minister Modi, any potential threats of sanctions would boomerang immediately'
- » Putin said that he has been in close talks with Prime Minister Modi for a long period, while recalling the time when the Indian leader was banned from entering the United States
- » 'I know PM Modi will never forget about it'

TELL THEM WE ARE NOT SCARED: ABHIJEET DIPKE

CJP's swarm, demand & deadline

Youth won't move as puppets: BJP | Congress remains on the sidelines

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: At its first protest meeting at Jantar Mantar in the heart of the Capital, not far away from Parliament House complex, the newly floated Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) on Saturday demanded Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation.

The gathering at the largely attended protest meet was led by the CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke and warned that the agitation would expand across the country if the Education Minister was not sacked or resigned on his own.

Activist Sonam Wangchuk, who also landed up at Jantar Mantar, described the gathering as "an appeal rather than a protest", saying the movement sought dialogue, not confrontation.

Addressing a press conference,



Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke during a protest demanding the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan over alleged examination-related lapses, at the Jantar Mantar

CJP spokespersons Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das said the protest had drawn participants from several states and marked the beginning of a broader youth movement centred on education and governance issues.

Birthing as an online campaign

in May, the CJP, which garnered over 22 million followers on Instagram, had exhorted youths to take part in the protest in the national capital over the issue of alleged irregularities in examinations and recruitment tests.

"We are giving the govern-

ment seven days. Either Dharmendra Pradhan should resign respectfully, or Prime Minister Narendra Modi should sack him. If his resignation does not come within seven days, this movement will spread throughout the country," Ranka said.

THE CALL

- » 'We are giving the government seven days. Either Dharmendra Pradhan should resign respectfully, or Prime Minister Narendra Modi should sack him'
- » 'If his resignation does not come within seven days, this movement will spread throughout the country'
- » Activist Sonam Wangchuk, who also landed up at Jantar Mantar, described the gathering as 'an appeal rather than a protest', saying the movement sought dialogue, not confrontation

Six years, 543 lives lost to fire

In the first half of 2026 alone, 65 fire deaths reported: Data

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Amid concerns being raised over fire safety measures in Delhi in the wake of Malviya Nagar hotel tragedy, official figures reveal that 543 people lost their lives in fire-related accidents in the city in the last six years.

Twenty-one people, mainly foreigners, lost their lives while 25 others were injured after a major fire tore through Flourish Stays B&B in a narrow bylane in south Delhi's Malviya Nagar on Wednesday.

Nine people each were killed in recent fire incidents in Vivek Vihar and Palam areas.

According to the Delhi government data, 543 people died in fire-related accidents from the year 2019 to March 2026.

In the first half of 2026 alone, 65 deaths in fire accidents have been reported.

The number of calls received by Delhi Fire Services (DFS) also witnessed a sharp rise in the last few years.

The DFS data showed that fire claimed a total 84 lives in 2025-26, 90 in 2024-25, and 77 in 2023-24.

While 41 such deaths were reported in 2020-21, 2021-22 saw 55. However, the numbers rose again in 2022-23, when 95 people

died in fire tragedies.

The highest number of deaths due to fire was reported in 2019-20: the Anaj Mandi fire, one of major fire incidents Delhi that saw the loss of 44 lives, and highest after 59 deaths in

LPG price up again: ₹29 hike per cylinder

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

NEW DELHI: Domestic cooking gas LPG price has been raised by Rs 29 per cylinder, marking the second increase in three months as state-owned fuel retailers continue to grapple with elevated global energy costs.

The price of a 14.2-kg LPG cylinder in Delhi will rise to Rs 942 from Rs 913 with effect from June 7, according to industry sources.

The increase follows a Rs 60-per-cylinder hike on March 7 after the conflict in West Asia disrupted global energy supplies and drove

up international fuel prices. Industry sources said that the increase had only partly offset losses incurred on domestic LPG sales.

State-run oil marketing companies were estimated to be losing about Rs 703 on every LPG cylinder sold before the latest revision, the sources said.

The LPG price hike comes amid a broader round of fuel price increases. Petrol and diesel prices have been raised by a cumulative Rs 7.50 per litre since mid-May, while compressed natural gas (CNG) rates have increased by about Rs 6 per kg.



'DELHI-SILIGURI BULLET TRAIN WILL CUT TRAVEL TIME TO 6 HRS FROM 20'

Railway projs worth about Rs 1L cr to be implemented in Bengal: CM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari on Saturday announced that Railway projects worth around Rs 1 lakh crore would be implemented in the state in the coming years.

Sharing the dais with Adhikari at Nabanna Sabhaghar, Union Railways minister Ashwini Vaishnaw announced a slew of projects for Bengal, including a bullet train network that would connect Delhi with Siliguri, the gateway to the northeast.

"A bullet train project will come to West Bengal. It will connect Delhi and Siliguri via Lucknow, Varanasi and Patna. The



Suwendu Adhikari with Ashwini Vaishnaw, in Kolkata, on Saturday

travel time will be just six hours from the present 20 hours," the Union minister said.

He further announced that Kolkata Metro would receive 60

DEV PROJECTS

- » Union Railway minister Ashwini Vaishnaw unveiled plans for a Delhi-Siliguri bullet train corridor, reducing travel time from about 20 hours to around 6 hours
- » The state expects major improvements in connectivity, with 538 railway overbridges, underpasses and related infrastructure projects planned across Bengal

points and clinch one of the most coveted trophies in elite chess.



R Praggnanandhaa

NORWAY CROWN FOR INDIA

Pragg's checkmate

AJAI MASAND

OSLO: Grandmaster R Praggnanandhaa etched his name in the history books as he became the first Indian to win the prestigious Norway Chess title with a final-round victory over Germany's Vincent Keymer here, capping off a brilliant campaign in style.

Praggnanandhaa, who began the final round in second place with 15 points on Friday, delivered when it mattered the most, securing a classical win worth three full points to finish on 18

Bengal courts big investments as Amul, L&T hold talks with CM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: Bengal is all set to have a significant investment in the dairy industry soon, with Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari on Saturday holding a meeting with Amit Vyas, the head of the Kaira District Co-operative Milk Producers' Union (Amul Dairy) and Jayen Mehta, Managing Director of the Gujarat Co-operative Milk Marketing Federation (GCMMF) known for its brand Amul at Nabanna.

The Chief Minister also stated in a social media post that he held a meeting "focused extensively on the industrial resurgence of West Bengal", with SN Subrahmanyam, chairman and Managing Director of Larsen & Toubro (L&T).

Soon after the dairy industry meeting, Adhikari took to his social media page and stated that investments and business expansion by a major, renowned organisation like Amul in West Bengal will play a pivotal role in the state's economic growth, employment generation, and the development of the dairy sector. "The meeting

GDP beats forecasts, but risks from West Asia conflict loom: Economists

NSO on Friday showed GDP growth accelerated to 7.8% in Jan-March qtr from 8% in preceding three months, taking full-year growth to 7.7%

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India's economy expanded at faster than expected rate in fiscal 2026 but economists cautioned that growth is likely to moderate this year amid rising energy costs and global uncertainty linked to the West Asia conflict.

Data released by the National Statistical Office (NSO) on Friday showed gross domestic product (GDP) growth accelerated to 7.8 per cent in the January-March quarter from 8 per cent in the preceding three months, taking full-year growth to 7.7 per cent, above the second advance estimate of 7.6 per cent.

Economists said resilient domestic demand, healthy private consumption and strong investment activity helped the economy weather the initial impact of the conflict in West Asia, which intensified during March.

"The growth was despite headwinds from the West Asia conflict," said Dharmakirti Joshi, Chief Economist at CRISIL, noting that fourth-quarter growth remained well above the average pace recorded over the previous 10 quarters.

Rumki Majumdar, economist at Deloitte India, said the expansion was broad-based and underpinned by both demand and production. Gross value added (GVA) growth of 7.9 per cent exceeded GDP growth, reflecting strength across services, manufacturing and construction.

Analysts, however, expect



'Resilient domestic demand, healthy private consumption & strong investment activity helped the economy weather the initial impact'

growth to slow in fiscal 2027 as higher crude oil and commodity prices, softer global growth, supply-chain disruptions and the prospect of a below-normal monsoon weigh on activity.

CRISIL maintained its FY27 GDP growth forecast at 6.6 per cent, while HDFC Bank projected growth at 6.5 per cent, assuming average crude oil prices of about \$95 per barrel. Both institutions warned that rising input costs, weaker exports, elevated inflation and a potential moderation in investment activity could dampen economic momentum.

DBS Bank said the economy entered the new fiscal year from a position of relative strength but cautioned that the full impact of the West Asia conflict is yet to be reflected in economic data. The lender flagged risks from disruptions in critical

Highlights

- » 'GVA growth of 7.9% exceeded GDP growth, reflecting strength across services, manufacturing and construction'
- » CRISIL maintained its FY27 GDP growth forecast at 6.6%, while HDFC Bank projected growth at 6.5%, assuming avg crude oil prices of \$95/barrel
- » 'In FY27 (April 2026 to March 2027) growth is set to weaken amid multiple headwinds'

input supplies, higher energy and food prices, and tighter financial conditions.

While economists remain broadly optimistic about India's domestic-demand driven growth story, most expect the economy to face a more challenging external environment this year, with risks to growth skewed to the downside.

"In fiscal 2027 (April 2026 to March 2027) growth is set to weaken amid multiple headwinds, including higher prices of crude and other commodities, softer global growth and forecast of a below-normal monsoon. Global supply chain disruptions are already intensifying cost pressures and reduced input availability is expected to add to the pressure," said Joshi of CRISIL.

"We maintain our GDP growth forecast for fiscal 2027 at

6.6 per cent, with risks tilted to the downside. Despite the slowdown in real GDP, the nominal GDP growth is set to be higher due to higher inflation based on both Wholesale Price Index and the Consumer Price Index."

Deloitte India's Rumki Majumdar said the fact that GVA growth at 7.9 per cent outpaced GDP growth suggests that India's expansion was not solely demand-driven but also backed by strong production momentum. Performance across services, manufacturing and construction indicates that the economy has entered a period of global uncertainty from a position of strength, which should help it better absorb potential supply-side shocks.

"We remain cautiously optimistic about the economic outlook in the next FY. We believe tensions in the Middle East will ease over the coming months and that associated supply-chain disruptions will gradually subside by the end of the year. India's strong domestic demand, coupled with proactive government intervention, should help cushion the economy from external headwinds. The government's front-loaded capital expenditure programme is already providing an important growth buffer at a time when private investment sentiment remains cautious," she said.

Majumdar said the government has absorbed a large part of the Middle East crisis in March by keeping pump prices of petrol and diesel stable while ensuring that LPG supply was maintained. "The gov-

ernment's measures to improve foreign investment flows into equities and government securities, address tax-related concerns and ease imports will help increase capital flows into the country, which will boost the momentum of investments that has picked up last year."

Radhika Rao, Senior Economist & Executive Director, DBS Bank said high frequency data for rural and urban demand points to relative resilience in the January-March quarter. "While the US-Iran conflict broke out towards the end of 4QFY26, output in the quarter was relatively insulated from bulk of adverse impact, with corporates tackling a build-up in cost pressures by tapping into inventories. Certain pockets of manufacturing activity, however, were impacted, including fertiliser, cement, etc."

Markets, she said, are likely to move on from the backward looking data and focus on potential spillover risks into FY27, particularly given the prospect of a prolonged disruption in the supply of critical inputs to downstream industries, higher energy as well as food costs impacting purchasing power and tighter financial conditions. "Policymakers also acknowledged downside risks to their baseline growth outlook stemming from uncertainty over the duration and intensity of the conflict. Nevertheless, they are likely to raise interest rates if the inflation outlook evolves in line with the projections presented in their quarterly forecast," she added.

Adani reclaims title of Asia's richest person with \$89.2 billion net worth

Gautam Adani surpassed Reliance Industries Chairman Mukesh Ambani and SoftBank CEO Masayoshi Son

NEW DELHI: Adani Group Chairman Gautam Adani has once again become Asia's richest person after a strong rally in Adani Group stocks lifted his net worth above those of Reliance Industries Chairman Mukesh Ambani and SoftBank Group CEO Masayoshi Son.

According to Forbes' real-time billionaire rankings, Adani's fortune has risen to \$89.2 billion, surpassing Ambani's \$88 billion and Son's \$87 billion. Son had briefly held the top spot in Asia before a decline in SoftBank shares on Thursday reduced his wealth.

The resurgence in Adani's fortune has been driven by a sharp rise in the group's listed companies. On Friday, Adani Green Energy shares surged nearly 7 per cent, while Adani Energy Solutions gained around 4 per cent. Adani Enterprises and Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone advanced about 2 per cent each, while Adani Power rose more than 1 per cent.

Adani Group stocks have gained between 23 per cent and 56 per cent so far in 2026.

Adani's net worth has increased by around \$10 billion since last month, aided by improved investor sentiment after the US Department of Justice (DoJ) dropped fraud-related charges against the conglomerate. The allegations, linked to an alleged \$250



Adani Group Chairman Gautam Adani

Adani's net worth has jumped by around \$10 bn since May on improved investor sentiment after US DoJ dropped charges of fraud against group

million bribery scheme involving solar power contracts, had earlier weighed on the group's shares.

The group had already been recovering from the fallout of a 2023 report by US short-seller Hindenburg Research, which accused it of stock manipulation and accounting fraud. The allegations triggered a sharp sell-off in Adani stocks, though

regulators later said the claims were not established.

Globally, Adani is ranked the world's 23rd-richest individual, ahead of Ambani and Son in the Forbes rankings. He was also among the biggest gainers on Friday, with his wealth increasing by about \$2.5 billion during the day.

Veteran investor Warren Buffett recorded the largest daily increase in wealth, adding nearly \$3 billion, according to Forbes.

At the top of the global wealth rankings, Elon Musk remains the world's richest person by a wide margin. He is followed by Google co-founder Larry Page, while fellow Google co-founder Sergey Brin occupies the next position among the world's wealthiest individuals.

AGENCIES

Adani Enterprises restores Surguja mine by planting 1.6 million trees

NEW DELHI: A coal mine in Chhattisgarh's Surguja district is being transformed into a green landscape through large-scale afforestation, with Adani Enterprises Ltd (AEL) planting more than 1.6 million trees and saplings across 568 hectares at the Parsa East and Kanta Basan (PEKB) mine.

The company operates the mine as developer and operator for Rajasthan Rajya Viduyt Utpadan Nigam Ltd (RVUNL). And its greening project has demonstrated how mined land can be restored after coal extraction, officials said.

It aims to increase the green cover to more than 4 million trees by the end of the decade as part of efforts to restore mined land and enhance biodiversity in the region.

Under the programme, 40 trees are planted for every tree removed for mining activities.



Native species including Sal, Mahua, Tendu, Amaltas and Sidha have been replanted, with the company reporting a survival rate of about 88 per cent.

Union Coal Ministry in a post on LinkedIn called the ecological restoration at PEBK coal mines as "remarkable" example of commitment.

"After coal extraction, the journey of a mine does not end - it marks the beginning of ecological restoration and sustainable transformation," it said. "The Parsa East & Kanta Basan (PEKB) Mine in Surguja, Chhattisgarh, stands as a remarkable example of this

commitment."

Once an active mining site, the area has now been transformed into a lush green landscape, reflecting how responsible mining practices and environmental conservation can go hand in hand, it said. "Today, the PEBK Mine is a living testament to the fact that mine closure can pave the way for a greener, more sustainable future."

Adani has also developed a 3.5-hectare nursery housing about 500,000 saplings and achieved successful regeneration of Sal forests in the area.

The company has undertaken compensatory afforestation across more than 4,000 hectares in Surguja, Korea, Balrampur and Surajpur forest divisions, while over Rs 259 crore has been deposited with the Chhattisgarh government towards afforestation, wildlife management and other environmental measures, officials said.

PTI

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No.: 230-Elect/TRD/PRYJ/EIG/2026

Dated: 05.06.2026

INDIAN RAILWAY

"INTRODUCTION OF AC 25 KV TRACTION"

"WARNING TO ROAD USERS"

It is notified for information of the Public that in connection with introduction of 25 KV AC electric traction over the section ARSHIYA Siding at KRJ station in between TDL-GZB section of Prayagraj division of North Central Railway, height gauges have been erected at all the level crossings with clear height of 4.78 mtr above road level with a view to prevent loads of excessive height from coming into contact or dangerous proximity to live traction wire (Contact Wire) which shall be at a height of minimum 5.5 m above the rail level at level crossings.

Public are hereby notified to observe the height specified above for the purpose of loading vehicles and to see that the loads carried in road vehicles do not infringe the height gauges under any circumstances.

The dangers of a load of excessive height are as follows:-

- (1) Danger to the height gauge and consequent obstruction to the road as well as the Railway line.
- (2) Danger to the materials or equipment carried or the vehicle itself.
- (3) Danger of the fire and risk of life due to contact with or dangerous proximity to the conductors.

Division: Prayagraj, Date of energization:- on or after 08.06.2026

Sr. Divt. Electrical Engineer (TR-D), North Central Railway, Prayagraj

1296/26 FA

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person(s) **Mohd Adnaan S/o: Mohd Azaj, R/o: H.No. 6278, Nawab Road, Gali Malvari, Sadar Bazar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 402/2020, U/s: 411 IPC, PS: Kashmere Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Mohd Adnaan**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Mohd Adnaan**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Mohd Adnaan, of FIR No. 402/2020, U/s: 411 IPC, PS: Kashmere Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.07.2026**.

By Order
Vaibhav Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11 (Central) Room No. 138
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/7088/N/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Fahim S/o Riyazuddin R/o K-201, JJ Colony, New Usmanpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case **FIR No. 24/2023 u/s 379/411/34 IPC at P.S. Kashmere Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Fahim** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Fahim** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **u/s 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Fahim** accused of **FIR No. 24/2023 u/s 379/411/34 IPC at P.S. Kashmere Gate, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **28.07.2026**.

By Order: Shri Vaibhav Garg,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11, (Central), Court No. 138, First Floor,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi.

DP/7455/N/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mohammad Akhalak, S/o: Mohammad Jabbar, R/o: Plot No-2A/D, Ranaji Enclave, Phase-2, Extn., Najafgarh Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 1004/2020, U/s: 498 IPC, P.S. Najafgarh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Mohammad Akhalak** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Mohammad Akhalak** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mohammad Akhalak of P.S. Najafgarh, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Ebbani Aggarwal
JMFC (Mahila Court)-03, South West Distt., Room No. 312,
Dwarka Courts, New Delhi

DP/7069/DW/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-AUCTION NOTICE

Senior Divisional Commercial Manager, North Central Railway, Prayagraj in terms of Railway Board letter dated 13.06.2022 invites bids through E-Auction module in IREPS for, Parcel(Leasing), Parking, in the following station/locations of Prayagraj Division.

Parcel Leasing	S. N.	Compartment	Train No.	CC (In tones)	From-To	Frequency (In a week)	E-Auction catalogue No.	E-Auction Start Date & Time
1.	FSLR-1	20433	3.9	SFG-SVDK	07 days	PRCL-PRYJ -26-04	19.06.2026, 11:30 Hrs	
2.	FSLR-1	12275	3.9	PRYJ-NDLS	04 days	PRCL-PRYJ -26-04	19.06.2026, 11:30 Hrs	

Parking	S. N.	Details of publicity	E-Auction catalogue No.	E-Auction Start Date & Time
1.	Available two wheeler, three wheeler & four wheeler Parking Stand at Kanpur Anwaraganj Railway Station for 05 Years.	PARKING-CPA-MX	09.06.2026 at 11:00 hrs	
2.	Two wheeler, three wheeler and four wheeler parking stand is available at Khurja Railway Station, Phaphund Railway Station, Rura Railway Station and Dankaur Railway Station for 03 years.	PARKING-PRYJ-MX	18.06.2026 at 11:00 hrs	

Interested bidders may visit the official website of the Indian Railway E-Procurement System (IREPS), www.ireps.gov.in, for detailed information, terms & conditions, and participation in the e-auction.

1285/26 (ADM)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely: **Bijender Kumar @ Vijender Kumar, S/o: Baljeet Singh Luhania, R/o: C-10/40, Sultan Puri, Delhi-110086** Also at: **Luhania Motor Works, P-1/266, Thane Wala Road, Sultan Puri, Delhi-100086** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case Reg. No.7347/2018 U/S 138 NI Act** registered at **P.S. Vijay Vihar, Rohini District, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Bijender Kumar @ Vijender Kumar** cannot be found and it has found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Bijender Kumar @ Vijender Kumar** is absconded (are is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Bijender Kumar @ Vijender Kumar, accused of Case Reg. No. 7347/2018 U/S 138 NI Act, P.S. Vijay Vihar, Rohini District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.07.2026**.

By Order, Sh. Sanyam Jain,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04 (North West), Room No. 112, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/7510/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

Vizag port berths cape sized bulk carrier

VISAKHAPATNAM: The Visakhapatnam Port has achieved a significant milestone by successfully berthing a 292-metre-long cape-sized bulk carrier (vessel) in the inner harbour.

Cape-sized bulk carriers are capable of carrying up to 2 lakh tonnes of deadweight and are too long to transit through the Panama Canal.

Hence, they navigate through the Cape of Good Hope, according to bulk-carrierguide.com. Incidentally, only a few ports in the world can accommodate such vessels in fully loaded condition.

MV Graceous, a cape-sized bulk carrier with 45 metres beam and a draft of 12.2 metres, had arrived at the port's EQ-1 berth, said an official press release from the Visakhapatnam Port Authority (VPA).

"VPA achieved a significant milestone with the successful berthing of MV GRACEOUS, a Cape-size bulk Carrier at EQ-1 berth in the inner harbour," it said on Friday. This achievement marks a historic moment for VPA, as the port now possesses more than one cape-compliant berth, further enhancing its capability to handle large bulk carriers and strengthening its cargo handling capacity.

Govt agencies, pvt cos among Indian entities given access to Mythos

NEW DELHI: A small number of Indian organisations, including government agencies and private firms, have secured access to Anthropic's Claude Mythos Preview AI model under the expanded Project Glasswing cybersecurity initiative, sources said. The number of Indian participants is currently in the single digits.

Project Glasswing is Anthropic's programme aimed

at improving cybersecurity by helping organisations identify software vulnerabilities using advanced AI tools. Launched in April with about 50 global partners, the initiative has reportedly helped uncover more than 10,000 high- and critical-severity security flaws.

This week, Anthropic expanded the programme to around 150 additional organisations across more than 15

nations, including operators of critical infrastructure in sectors such as power, water, healthcare, communications and hardware.

The company said participating organisations are those whose compromise could have far-reaching consequences.

Access to the model is expected to help users detect vulnerabilities, test cyber defences and accelerate software patching.

AGENCIES

Centre mandates standard size edible oil pack

NEW DELHI: The Department of Consumer Affairs has prescribed standard pack sizes for edible oils under the Legal Metrology framework, a move aimed at helping consumers compare prices across brands and make informed purchasing decisions.

The department has amended its Standard Operating Procedure (SoP) for determination of net quantity and standard pack sizes of edible oils and fats, giving manufacturers, packers and importers a three-month transition period to comply with the new norms, an official statement said.

The revised SoP prescribes nine standard pack sizes - 200 ml/g, 500 ml/g, 1 litre/kg, 2 litre/kg, 3 litre/kg, 4 litre/kg, 5 litre/kg, 15 litre/kg and 20 litre/kg-for major edible oils including palm, soybean, sunflower, mustard, groundnut, sesame, rice bran, cottonseed and corn oil, as well as blended edible oils.

PTI

Hotel fire probe widens, cook held

Court sends cook to 2 days police custody

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has arrested the cook of a south Delhi hotel where a devastating fire killed 21 people earlier this week, with investigators alleging that his negligence played a role in triggering the blaze, officials said on Saturday.

Several other individuals connected with the establishment have also been detained and are being questioned as part of the ongoing investigation into the fire at Flourish Stays Bed and Breakfast in Malviya Nagar's Hauz Rani area, they said.

According to police sources, preliminary findings indicate that the actions of the cook, identified as Keshav Negi, may have contributed to the outbreak of the fire. Investigators are examining the exact sequence of events and the circumstances that led to the blaze, while questioning hotel staff and other persons associated with the property's operations. The latest arrest comes as the Delhi Police widens its probe into the tragedy, examining alleged safety violations, unauthorised expansion of rooms and the role of individuals involved in the management and day-to-day functioning of the hotel.

The blaze ripped through the hotel on Wednesday morning, killing 21 people, including a 16-year-old girl and several foreign nationals from Kyrgyzstan, Nigeria, Bangladesh, Iraq, Congo, Mozambique and Liberia. Police had



Police personnel keep a vigil at the spot

Five weaned off ventilators; one remains on life support

NEW DELHI: Five patients injured in the Delhi hotel fire and undergoing treatment at Max Hospital's Saket complex were successfully taken off ventilator support on Saturday, while one patient remains on life support, the hospital said.

According to the hospital, all five patients who were weaned off ventilators are stable and showing signs of improvement. A total of 15 patients are currently admitted at the hospital, including 13 international patients affected by the fire incident. AGENCIES

earlier arrested hotel owner Lavkesh Bajaj and booked him under charges including culpable homicide not amounting to murder. Investigators are probing whether negligence, violations of fire safety norms and unauthorised alterations to the property contributed to the high death toll.

Authorities also found alleged deficiencies in fire

safety measures and ventilation at the premises.

Meanwhile, a Delhi court sent to two days of police custody the cook. Judicial Magistrate Bhanu Pratap Singh was hearing Delhi Police's petition to interrogate cook Keshav Negi for two days and allowed the plea. Negi was arrested earlier in the day with investigators blaming his negligence.

India's youth ready to lead nation-building: CM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Saturday attended the 'Youth for Viksit Bharat - MY Bharat Youth Convention' organised by the Union Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports at Thyagaraj Stadium, where more than 6,000 young participants from across the country gathered to celebrate youth achievement and leadership.

Union Minister for Youth Affairs and Sports Mansukh Mandaviya and several prominent personalities from sports, entrepreneurship, arts, administration and content creation were also present at the event, according to an official release.

Addressing the gathering, Gupta described the conven-



CM Rekha Gupta with sports minister Mansukh Mandaviya and BJP MLA Maithili Thakur during the MY Bharat Youth Convention on Saturday

tion as a celebration of India's youth power and said the presence of talented youngsters from diverse fields made the event feel like 'stars on earth'.

"When young entrepre-

neurs, athletes, artists, public representatives, content creators and successful UPSC candidates come together on one platform, it reflects India's immense talent and limitless

potential," she said.

Praising the initiative, Gupta congratulated Mandaviya for creating a platform that not only recognises young achievers but also motivates them to contribute towards nation-building.

She said the convention demonstrated that India's youth were fully prepared to shoulder the country's future responsibilities and had already set new benchmarks in sports, technology, education, entrepreneurship, administration and the arts.

Urging youngsters to actively participate in the country's growth story, Gupta said, "If every young Indian takes one step forward, the nation of 1.4 billion people moves ahead together."

Hydroponic weed worth Rs 2.1 cr seized

NEW DELHI: Customs officials at Delhi's Indira Gandhi International (IGI) Airport have seized over 6 kg of suspected hydroponic weed, valued at around Rs 2.1 crore from an Indian passenger arriving from Bangkok and booked a case under the provisions of the NDPS Act, officials said on Saturday.

Hydroponic weed is a high-potency variety of cannabis cultivated in nutrient-rich water instead of soil.

According to an official statement, the passenger arrived in Delhi from Bangkok on June 3 and was intercepted after crossing the green channel on the basis of profiling.

During X-ray screening of the passenger's baggage, "suspicious images were noticed". AGENCIES

MCD boosts healthcare, reviews Ghazipur landfill operations

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Marking World Environment Day, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Saturday announced major healthcare upgrades at Swami Dayanand Hospital while also reviewing ongoing waste management efforts at the Ghazipur landfill site.

Mayor Pravesh Wahi inaugurated a newly built Advanced Operation Theatre (OT) Block at Swami Dayanand Hospital and dedicated two 4K laparoscopic surgery systems and a C-Arm imaging machine to the public. The equipment, installed at a combined cost of over Rs 2 crore, is expected to enhance the hospital's capacity to perform minimally invasive, orthopaedic and trauma-related surgeries.



Speaking at the event, Wahi said the civic body was committed to modernising its healthcare infrastructure and ensuring access to advanced medical facilities for residents. He added that the new equipment would improve the quality, precision and safety of surgical procedures.

Standing Committee Chairperson Satya Sharma said technological upgrades were essential to strengthening public healthcare services, while Leader of the House Jai Bhag-

wan Yadav noted that the facilities would benefit residents of East Delhi by reducing the need to seek specialised treatment elsewhere.

The Mayor also participated in a plantation drive on the hospital campus, highlighting the importance of environmental conservation alongside public health initiatives.

Earlier in the day, Deputy Mayor Monica Pant inspected the Ghazipur landfill site as part of the MCD's World Environment Day campaign.

CM inaugurates Coforge public library in Vasant Kunj

NEW DELHI: A strong reading culture nurtures informed minds, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said while inaugurating a Coforge Public Library in Vasant Kunj in south Delhi.

The library is the Coforge company's flagship Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiative and this is the fourth such facility in India after Noida, Gurugram and Hyderabad.

"This magnificent space is far more than just a building; it is a gateway to knowledge, equality, and opportunity. It represents a profound understanding that true progress lies in empowering minds. We highly commend Coforge for recognising the transformative power of books," the chief minister said at the event. "I offer my warmest congratulations and best wishes to the entire Coforge family. May this grand initiative inspire many more such sanctuaries of knowledge across Delhi and the rest of India, opening new doors of growth for every citizen," she added.

Anuradha Sehgal, Chief Brand and Sustainability Officer of Coforge, said, "All Coforge Public Library

Highlights

» The library is the Coforge company's flagship Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiative and this is the fourth such facility in India after Noida, Gurugram and Hyderabad.

» The library in Vasant Kunj will be a shared space for the entire community in and around Vasant Kunj, Sehgal added

locations are selected with a clear social objective, to serve dense population clusters, including underserved communities where access to quality reading infrastructure is limited."

The library in Vasant Kunj will be a shared space for the entire community in and around Vasant Kunj, Sehgal added.

Entry and reading are completely free, and visitors may also borrow books by paying a fully refundable deposit. No deposit is taken from students of government schools. MPOST

Man jumps to death after stabbing mother

NOIDA: A 21-year-old man allegedly jumped to his death from the fifth floor of a residential building in Greater Noida on Saturday after reportedly attacking his mother with a knife during an altercation, police said.

The incident took place at Radha Sky Garden Society under the jurisdiction of the Bishrakhpur police station.

The deceased was identified as Sagar Yadav, who lived in the housing society with his parents and younger brother. According to police officials, Yadav was allegedly suffering from mental health issues and was not mentally stable.

Police said an argument broke out between Yadav and his mother at their flat on Saturday. During the altercation, he allegedly attacked her with a knife, causing injuries.

Two arrested for stabbing man to death after quarrel

NEW DELHI: A man was allegedly stabbed to death following a quarrel near northwest Delhi's Shalimar Bagh area, an official said on Saturday. Two accused, identified as Saurabh alias Tola and Sachin alias Chiddi, were arrested while allegedly attempting to flee after the crime, police said.

According to police, information was received regarding a man having been admitted to a hospital with stab injuries sustained during a quarrel in the area. He later succumbed to his injuries during treatment.

An FIR was registered and an investigation launched. Police teams examined CCTV footage from the locality, analysed technical evidence and worked on local intelligence inputs to identify the suspects involved in the killing.

"Using technical surveillance and secret information, the police team tracked down and arrested both accused. During interrogation, the accused allegedly disclosed their involvement in the crime. At their instance, police recovered the knife used in the offence," a police officer said. AGENCIES

Delhi Police busts seven cyber fraud syndicates, 14 held

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has busted seven major interstate cyber fraud syndicates and arrested 14 alleged cyber criminals during a month-long crackdown in May in central Delhi, an official said on Saturday.

The operation targeted a range of cybercrime modules, including fake government websites, algorithm-based trading scams, malicious mobile applications, work-from-home frauds and online spiritual healing rackets, operating across several states.

The accused were arrested from Rajasthan, Punjab, Karnataka, Madhya Pradesh, Haryana and Uttar Pradesh. The crackdown exposed fraud networks involving transactions worth more than Rs 2 crore

and led to the recovery of luxury vehicles, electronic devices, a cryptocurrency hardware wallet, debit cards and other digital evidence.

One of the major cases involved a fake government portal, "parivahan.online", which allegedly mimicked the official transport department website and was used to collect payments from unsuspecting users seeking vehicle-related services. Police arrested Anshul Yadav (24), an MCA graduate from Uttar Pradesh's Etawah district, and recovered laptops, mobile phones and source files linked to the fake website.

In another major breakthrough, police dismantled an alleged algorithm-based trading scam in which fraudsters lured victims through social media groups

and persuaded them to invest money through a fake application by promising high returns.

Investigators identified a transaction trail of nearly Rs 2 crore and traced over 14,000 fraudulent transactions linked to the racket. Police said 636 victims connected to the scam have been identified and informed. Three accused -- Ravi Rathore, an IT engineer, Vikash Rathod and Sudama -- were arrested in connection with the case. Police recovered an SUV, computers, laptops and mobile phones from them.

In a separate case, police arrested four persons allegedly running an online "spiritual healer" racket that preyed on people facing personal and emotional difficulties. AGENCIES

Delhi takes wing with 471 bird species

Only Bogotá ranks ahead in bird diversity among capitals

NEW DELHI: Delhi is the world's second-richest capital for avian diversity after Nairobi, hosting 471 bird species, according to the city's first comprehensive Delhi Bird Atlas.

The atlas was prepared by the Delhi Forest Department in collaboration with Bird Count India as a city-wide citizen science initiative to systematically map the distribution and abundance of bird species across the city. The report presents findings from the first year of a two-year survey exercise that began in January 2025, officials said.

Under the project, Delhi was divided into grids measuring 6.6 km by 6.6 km, with 145 randomly selected sub-cells covering around 11 per cent of the city's area.



In Short

» The report presents findings from the first year of a two-year survey exercise that began in January 2025, officials said

Teams of two to five bird-watchers conducted standardised surveys on foot

» Under the project, Delhi was divided into grids measuring 6.6 km by 6.6 km, with 145 randomly selected sub-cells covering around 11 per cent of the city's area

during winter and summer seasons to document resident and migratory species.

Of the total 221 species documented during the first year of surveys, 108 species (48.87 per cent) were classified as invertebrate feeders, 37 species (16.74 per cent) as plant and seed feeders, 34 species (15.38 per cent) as omnivores, 33 species (14.93 per cent) as vertebrate and carrion feeders, and nine species (4.07 per cent) as fruit and nectar feeders.

Invertebrate-feeding birds constituted nearly half of the total assemblage, while fruit and nectar feeders represented the smallest proportion.

The atlas also recorded the presence of several species of conservation concern, including the Endangered Black-bellied Tern and Near Threatened species such as the

Asian Woolly-necked Stork, Painted Stork, Black-headed Ibis and Oriental Darter. "This data will help researchers and urban planners better understand biodiversity and make informed decisions for conservation and urban development," said Pankaj Gupta, State Coordinator, Bird Count India.

According to the atlas, Delhi's location at the northern edge of the Aravalli hills, the Yamuna and Sahibi floodplains, and its position along the Central Asian Flyway help sustain one of the richest bird assemblages among world capitals. The atlas describes itself as a long-term effort to create a scientific baseline for monitoring bird populations, assessing habitat health. AGENCIES

Gurugram police busts fake call centre in Delhi

GURUGRAM: The Gurugram police busted a fake call centre allegedly involved in a credit card scam operating from Delhi's Janakpuri area and arrested five accused, including a woman, police said on Saturday.

They have been operating for the past five months and have been evading police by changing their location every 10 to 15 days, they added.

The matter came to light on March 11 after a person filed a complaint at the Police Station Cyber Crime South, saying that he was cheated of approximately Rs 28,000 after receiving an online link from fraudsters claiming to increase his credit card limit. Based on the complaint, a case was registered. Under the supervision of

Assistant Commissioner of Police (Cyber) Gaurav Phogat, a police team led by Inspector Naveen Kumar raided the call centre in Janakpuri and the five scammers on Friday, said police. The accused were identified as Rahul (33), a resident of Baljit Nagar, Delhi, Anuj Pal (20), Gaurav (24), Mukul Kiran (22), all residents of Delhi's Indrapuri, and Anchal (21), a resident of Tilak Nagar.

During the interrogation, it was revealed that the accused defrauded victims by offering to increase their credit card limits. They worked on Rahul's instructions and received salaries for their work. He provided them with customer data, after which they would call people claiming to increase their credit card limits. AGENCIES

CAQM reviews 245 NCR inspections

NEW DELHI: The CAQM Enforcement Task Force (ETF) has reviewed reports from 245 inspections and enforcement actions carried out in the National Capital Region area between May 11 and May 29 at its 132nd meeting.

The flying squads carried out 31 inspections across construction and demolition sites, 74 inspections across the industrial sector, and 140 inspections related to diesel generator sets.

A total of 87 violations were reported, including 21 from construction and demolition sites, 25 from the industrial sector and 41 across diesel generator sets.

"The ETF also reviewed the issue of road dust mitigation and took note of inspections carried out by Greater Noida Industrial Development Authority on May 18," an official said on Saturday.

During these inspections, nine areas were examined, and 37 violations were reported.

The ETF examined inspections conducted by Municipal Corporation Ghaziabad on May 26, covering four areas where 24 violations were reported.

"Moreover, the Commission for Air Quality Management has emphasised the need for timely submission of inspection reports by flying squad teams along with photographic/video evidence," said the official.

During the meeting, the commission reiterated the need for robust enforcement, strengthened inter-agency coordination and strict adherence to prescribed environmental norms to ensure abatement of air pollution across NCR. AGENCIES

Speaker Gupta calls for recognition of tribals

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta on Saturday said tribal histories are not peripheral to India's story; they are integral to its civilisational journey.

Speaker Gupta, who was attending a national seminar on 'Bhagwan Shri Birsa Munda' at the India International Centre, called for greater recognition of tribal heritage.

"Bhagwan Shri Birsa Munda occupies a unique and inspiring place in India's history. He was not merely a freedom fighter but a symbol of self-respect, cultural identity and social awakening. His legacy reminds us that the protection of rights and the preservation of culture are inseparable," Gupta said.

'The protection of rights and the preservation of culture are inseparable'

Organised by the Museums Association of India, the seminar brought together museum professionals, historians, archaeologists, scholars and researchers to deliberate upon the enduring legacy of tribal leader Birsa Munda.

Addressing the gathering, Gupta said Birsa Munda's movement represented not only resistance to colonial rule but also a determined effort to protect cultural identity, traditional institutions and indigenous ways of life.

NDMC camp hears 61 civic grievances

ANAMTA FATIMA



NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) on Saturday received and addressed 61 public grievances during a Suvidha Camp organised at the NDCC Convention Centre on Jai Singh Road, as part of its efforts to strengthen citizen engagement and improve service delivery.

According to the civic body, most complaints were related to the Personnel, Civil Engineering, Horticulture, Public Health, Enforcement, Commercial, Tax and Estate Departments. In addition to grievance submissions, a large number of residents visited the camp to seek information about civic services and welfare initiatives offered by the NDMC.

A notable feature of the camp was the direct interaction between citizens and departmental officials, enabling quicker understanding of issues and facilitating on-the-spot resolutions wherever possible. Cases requiring policy-level intervention were also discussed.

'NOT FORUM FOR PEDDLING BIASED AND FALSE NARRATIVES'

UNSC membership huge responsibility: India slams Pak

UNITED NATIONS: India has slammed Pakistan for its “unwarranted reference” to Jammu and Kashmir at the UN, telling the current non-permanent member of the global body that it was a huge responsibility and not a forum for peddling “biased and false narratives”.

“The unwarranted reference by Pakistan to a matter strictly internal to India, the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir, has compelled me to respond,” India’s Permanent Representative to the UN Ambassador Parvathaneni Harish said on Friday.

The strong retort by Harish came after Pakistan’s Permanent Representative to the UN Ambassador Asim Iftikhar Ahmad raised the issue of Jammu and Kashmir in his remarks in the UN General Assembly on Friday on the ‘Annual Report of the Security Council’.

Highlights

- » ‘The unwarranted reference by Pakistan to a matter strictly internal to India, the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir, has compelled me to respond’
- » Harish said in the UNGA hall that Pakistan has decided not to spare this forum either from their characteristic misuse of august UN platforms

ity Council’.

Pakistan, which constantly raises the issue of Jammu and Kashmir as well as other topics internal to India at various UN platforms, currently sits in the Security Council as a non-permanent member and its tenure will end this year.

Harish said in the UNGA hall that Pakistan has decided not to spare this forum either from their characteristic misuse of august UN platforms for their divisive political interests.

“Abuse of its presence on the Security Council by Pakistan, including through the

circulation of several misinformed and misleading communications also testifies to this counter-productive approach. I would like to remind Pakistan that being a member of the UN Security Council is a huge responsibility. It is not a forum for peddling biased and false narratives,” Harish said.

Making it clear that Jammu and Kashmir was, is and will always remain an integral and inalienable part of India, Harish emphasised that any assertions to the contrary are baseless, devoid of and inconsistent with historical facts.

“Empty rhetoric and hollow claims by Pakistan would not change this fundamental reality. In the interest of time of the wider UN membership, I would not delve any further into this,” he said.

The Indian envoy also pointed out that the international community recognises the importance of reform of the Security Council to make it fit-for-purpose to handle contemporary and future challenges we face.

“The current structure reflects geopolitical realities of 1945. Retaining the status quo has so far not enabled effective functioning of the Security Council and cannot do so in future,” he said.

He noted that the “marginal” reform in the 1960s that expanded only the non-permanent category has not changed the fundamental mode of functioning of

the Security Council in any impactful manner.

“Expansion of both permanent and non-permanent categories is central to implementing real and meaningful reform,” he said.

The G4 nations of India, Brazil, Germany and Japan have proposed that Security Council membership needs to be increased from the current 15 to 25 or 26, with a reformed Council consisting of 11 permanent members and 14 or 15 non-permanent members.

Currently, the powerful UN organ consists of five veto-wielding permanent members — China, France, Russia, the UK and the US.

The remaining 10 members are elected to sit at the horse-shoe table for two-year terms as non-permanent members. India last sat in the Council as a non-permanent member in 2021-22.

AGENCIES

OPERATION BLUESTAR ANNIVERSARY

Akal Takht Jathedar gives call for Sikh unity, raises issue of anti-sacrilege law

OUR CORRESPONDENT

AMRITSAR: The Sikh community should remain united and connected to their roots in Punjab, Akal Takht Jathedar Giani Kuldip Singh Gargaji said on Saturday, the 42nd anniversary of Operation Bluestar, and expressed concern that Sikh identity and religious symbols were being “targeted globally”.

Addressing a gathering, the Jathedar (head priest) also raised the issue of the anti-sacrilege law and criticised what he described as attempts by governments to impose laws and exercise control over Sikh institutions.

Operation Bluestar was carried out in June 1984 to flush out militants from the Golden Temple, the holiest shrine of Sikhism.

Sikh religious bodies observed the anniversary of Operation Bluestar which passed off peacefully, though pro-Khalistan slogans were raised by supporters and activists of radical Sikh outfits outside the Akal Takht, the



Members of various Sikh organisations raise ‘pro-Khalistan’ slogans, at the Golden Temple, in Amritsar, Punjab, Saturday PTI

supreme temporal seat of Sikhs. Mann was also present on the spot.

Supporters of Khadoor Sahib MP Amritpal Singh were also seen with his portraits. Singh is currently lodged in a jail in Assam in the 2023 Police Station attack case.

Radical Sikh outfit Dal Khalsa’s activists were seen carrying photographs of the damaged Akal Takht and hold-

ing placards bearing portraits of slain militant leader Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale. The entire marbled periphery of the Golden Temple echoed with pro-Khalistan slogans.

Jathedar Gargaji said governments must always remember that Sikhs are equal citizens in India and not second-class citizens. Policies perceived as discriminatory towards Sikhs are not in the country’s interest, he said in his address.

He expressed concern that Sikh identity and religious symbols “were increasingly being targeted globally through various pretexts under deep-rooted conspiracy”.

He urged Sikh organisations worldwide to remain vigilant and appealed to Sikhs living abroad to maintain strong ties with Punjab, ensure their children remain connected to their roots, avoid permanently leaving Punjab and refrain from selling ancestral lands.

“It is very important to remain connected to our roots and strengthen it to counter future big challenges,” he said.

From Page 1

Gulf tensions

Earlier in the week, Iranian drones heavily damaged a passenger terminal at Kuwait’s main airport, killing one person and wounding dozens.

The US military kept up its blockade on Iranian ports in response to Tehran’s chokehold on the crucial corridor for global oil and natural gas shipments, which has sent energy prices spiking and posed political problems for President Donald

Trump’s Republican Party ahead of midterm congressional elections.

Despite concerns that the ceasefire could collapse, Trump told reporters Friday that “the situation with Iran seems to be going quite well.” He told an event that “we’re going to come out of Iran very quickly and it’s going to be very strong one way or the other, whether it’s a piece of paper or the very tough way.”

Meanwhile, the ongoing fighting in Lebanon, where Israeli forces have seized large swaths of the south while saying it targets the Iranian-backed Hezbollah militant group, also challenges efforts to end the Iran war and reopen the Strait of Hormuz. Iran has demanded that any lasting truce extend to Lebanon.

The Trump administration has touted the latest ceasefire agreed to earlier in the week by the Lebanese government and Israel after US-brokered talks in Washington. However, Hezbollah has rejected the agreement.

Israeli airstrikes on southern Lebanon on Saturday killed nine people, including three members of the Lebanese military, the Lebanese army and state media said. Israel’s military said it was reviewing the incident and that it operates against Hezbollah and not the Lebanese army.

Six years

Upahar fire tragedy in 1997. A total of 4,403 people sustained injuries in fire-related incidents between 2019 and 2025, according to the data.

It also showed that the number of emergency calls received by the Delhi Fire Services regarding fire-related incidents has risen over the years from 17,231 in 2019-20 to 20,379 in the last financial year.

Pragg’s

In doing so, the 20-year-old Chennai player achieved a feat that had eluded even Indian chess legend Viswanathan Anand and reigning world champion D Gukesh among others, since the tournament’s inception in 2013.

Competing in Norway Chess for only the second time, Pragganandhaa endured a slow start in the elite six-player field before gathering momentum in the second half of the event to secure four wins on the trot.

His campaign was highlighted by a remarkable achievement -- defeating seven-time Norway Chess champion and World No. 1 Magnus Carlsen twice in classical chess -- a rare accomplishment that underlined his determination to bounce back from the disappointment of an underwhelming Candidates Tournament in Paphos earlier this year.

As reigning world champion Gukesh fell out of contention in the closing stages, Pragganandhaa ensured that India’s challenge remained alive, ultimately carrying it all the way to the title.

The result was made possible after American Grandmaster Wesley So, who led the standings with 15.5 points heading into the final round, was held to a draw in his classical game against Alireza Firouzja, sending their contest into an Armageddon tie-break.

That outcome opened the door for Pragganandhaa, who knew that a classical victory over Keymer would propel him to the top of the standings and secure a landmark title.

Although Wesley So went on to win the Armageddon tie-break, the victory was worth only 1.5 points, taking his tally to 17 points -- one short of Pragganandhaa’s winning total of 18.

Alireza, who had also entered the final round with title hopes, finished third with 15.5 points.

A beaming Pragganandhaa revealed after the match that a pep talk from his mother back home in Chennai had lifted his spirits.

“She told me that June would bring good luck,” he said with a smile -- a prediction that came true.

“I was speaking to my mother on June 1, before Alireza’s game, and she was telling me, ‘It’s a new month, you’ll play well!’ It’s just one of those things that mum always says, and then these four games I won. She knew something, I guess,” said Pragganandhaa.

Pragganandhaa went on to string together four consecutive victories after that.

Even Carlsen, the record seven-time Norway Chess champion, was effusive in his praise for Pragganandhaa, describing the Indian youngster’s performance as “superb” throughout the tournament.

Such wholehearted admiration is not something the Norwegian legend hands out lightly -- especially not to a rival in the same generation as Gukesh -- underscoring just how impressive Pragganandhaa’s title-winning campaign had been.

“That’s pretty insane. That’s as clutch as it gets, and it just shows that it would have been possible for me as well with a similar finish, but yeah, that’s incredible. It shows you the volatility of the system, and he is an incredible fighter, and it’s fun to see him get rewarded for that,” Carlsen told the broadcaster.

Pragganandhaa later admitted, during his second visit to the “confession box,” that he had missed a strong continuation that could have wrapped up the game much sooner. Despite letting that opportunity slip, he remained determined to keep probing.

His persistence eventually

paid off as the pressure began to tell on Keymer. In an endgame that had appeared roughly balanced, the German faltered with a series of inaccuracies, culminating in the weakening 30...h5? which fatally exposed the g5 square and tilted the game decisively in Pragganandhaa’s favour.

Meanwhile, Gukesh’s disappointing campaign continued as his third appearance in the tournament ended without the breakthrough he had hoped for in a year when he is set to defend his world title against challenger Javokhir Sindarov.

In the final round, Carlsen, playing with the white pieces, defeated the 20-year-old Indian in a classical game to collect three full points. However, the victory was not enough to propel the Norwegian great into title contention, as he finished fifth in the standings with 13 points.

Results (Round 10): Open: Alireza Firouzja (Fra, 15.5) lost to Wesley So (USA, 17); Magnus Carlsen (Nor, 13) bt D. Gukesh (Ind,); R. Pragganandhaa (Ind, 18) bt Vincent Keymer (11).

Women: Zhu Jiner (Chn, 16) by Koneru Humpy (Ind, 9); Ju Wenjun (Chn, 13.5) bt Bibisara Assaubayeva (Kaz, 16.5); Anna Muzychuk (Ukr, 15) bt Divya Deshmukh (Ind, 10).

PTI

Bengal courts

covered detailed discussions regarding the organisation’s expansion in West Bengal, investment prospects, and the development of the dairy industry,” Adhikari wrote on his Facebook page.

He claimed that the discussion was highly productive and expressed optimism that the mutual cooperation between West Bengal and Amul will open up new horizons in the future.

Amul is likely to invest Rs 650 crore in a mega project in West Bengal which is expected to strengthen the dairy infrastructure in the state while also creating significant employment opportunities.

The Chief Minister also held a meeting with SN Subrahmanyan, chairman and Managing Director of Larsen & Toubro (L&T).

Elucidating about the meeting, the CM wrote on his X handle: “During our 30-minute discussion, we focused extensively on the industrial resurgence of West Bengal. We exchanged ideas on creating a robust ecosystem for industrial development, attracting mega investments and accelerating economic growth to generate meaningful employment opportunities for the Youth of our State.”

He added: “West Bengal has immense potential, and strategic collaborations with industrial leaders can play a pivotal role in transforming the state’s economic landscape.”

Railway projs

The Union minister lashed out at the previous Trinamool Congress-led government in Bengal, accusing it of delaying several Railway and Metro proj-

ects. He cited the metro project at Chingrighata, where work on a key stretch was delayed due to court battles.

“Projects valued at around Rs 1.02 lakh crore have been pending implementation for a long time... You may recall the case of the metro project at Chingrighata, where the TMC government pursued legal challenges all the way to the Supreme Court. Their attitude was not to allow any development works,” Vaishnaw said.

Highlighting the emphasis of Prime Minister Narendra Modi for Metro projects in Bengal, he pointed out that Kolkata Metro, India’s first metro rail system, added only 28 km of network in the 42 years between 1972 and 2014, while after Prime Minister Modi came to power in 2014, 45 kilometres of metro lines have been completed in just 12 years.

Adhikari assured complete cooperation from the Bengal government for railway projects, including acquiring land and handing it over to the Railways wherever necessary.

“I have given clear instructions that district administrations must facilitate railway expansion across West Bengal. The Railways provides funds for land acquisition, and wherever required, the state will acquire land and hand it over to the Railways,” Adhikari said.

He also directed officials to prepare a timeline indicating when and where land could be made available for railway projects.

Accusing the former state TMC government of maintaining a confrontational approach towards the Centre, resulting in delays in development projects, Adhikari claimed nearly 61 Railway projects approved by the Centre in October–November last year had remained stalled due to pending state clearances.

“These projects will now be implemented, and districts from the remote Sagar Islands in Sunderbans to the North Bengal border will witness a revolutionary transformation in the railway connectivity,” said the Chief Minister.

Comparing Railway funding under the former UPA government with allocations under the Modi government, Adhikari claimed that West Bengal received Rs 4,380 crore for Railway and Metro projects between 2009 and 2014, while Rs 14,205 crore had been allocated for Railway projects in the state in the 2026–27 financial year.

The Chief Minister said 538 Railway overbridges, underpasses and related infrastructure projects would be developed and claimed that 40 NOCs for railway underpasses have already been issued.

The Railway minister, who received a booklet from BJP legislators regarding requisitions associated with the development of Railway infrastructure, said that he would take them up on a priority basis with Adhikari and do the needful.

The Railway minister’s visit marked his first trip to Kolkata since the BJP government assumed office in West Bengal a month ago.

During his visit, Vaishnaw travelled on the Kolkata Metro from Jai Hind Station to Noapara Station and interacted with fel-

low passengers to understand their travel experience and gather feedback on Metro services.

At a Metro station, the minister also met with sanitation staff and appreciated their efforts in maintaining cleanliness. He then chose to travel by auto-rickshaw from Noapara to the Belghoria Expressway before reaching Nabanna Sabhaghar for reviewing Railway projects in Bengal along with the CM.

After the meeting, Vaishnaw visited the Chingrighata Metro stretch where work remained pending for a long time. However, with the new government taking over, the pending work was completed within two days after receiving the necessary approval.

Meanwhile, the Chief Minister, in the evening, attended a programme at Dhonodhanya Auditorium organised to celebrate “Sanatan consciousness and the Awakening of Ram Rajya in Banga Bhoomi”.

Adhikari at the programme said that efforts are being made to make Ganga Sagar Mela an international fair. He said that Bengal is not only the cultural capital but also the spiritual capital.

He said that the BJP government would uplift the condition of the Dakshineswar temple and Kalighat.

He also alleged that the earlier TMC government had indulged in appeasement politics and violence. But now the state is on the path of development.

Adhikari also held a review meeting at Nabanna with Health department officials and discussed how to accelerate the implementation of the “TB Mukta Bharat”. A few days ago, the Chief Minister held a meeting with the Union Health minister where the issue was also taken up.

Putin

No matter what people say, India has always been acting in this manner.”

“India is always guided by its national interests,” he added.

Putin said that Russia’s cooperation with India, just like with all other partners, is not subject to the political environment.

“We can’t be dictated... Nobody can dictate to us, and nobody would even try to do that. We are always going to do what we consider to be right, and we will always stand true to the commitments given to partners, especially partners like India,” he said. Highlighting Russia’s longstanding relationship with India, especially in the area of defence, Putin said, “Our relations with the Indian friends are specific, thanks to our mutual trust. We concentrate not just on trade. Not just on buying and selling, we’re also concentrating on joint research and development.”

Putin highlighted how experts from both countries are working on the design of the mid-range missile BrahMos.

On the fifth-generation stealth aircraft Sukhoi Su-57, Putin said Russia had earlier proposed a joint development programme with India, but later pursued the project independently after the plan did not materialise.

“Su-57 is a very good aircraft, probably the most modern

one, the most up-to-date in the world as of now,” Putin said. “We offered that we should do that together. Well, it didn’t work out, but we did it on our own, and we stand ready to sell Su-57.”

For decades, Russia has served as India’s primary defence supplier. However, persistent supply chain disruptions and delivery delays stemming from the war in Ukraine have forced New Delhi to aggressively diversify its military procurement strategy.

After a years-long search for a fifth-generation fighter jet, India has launched its ambitious Advanced Multirole Combat Aircraft (AMCA) project, widely regarded as the nation’s largest indigenous aerospace programme.

As the aircraft under the AMCA project is unlikely to join the Indian Air Force (IAF) before 2035, the government is considering the procurement of at least two squadrons (around 36) of Su-57s, provided they fulfil the technical specifications.

CJP’s swarm

He said the organisers were receiving messages from supporters in different states expressing readiness to hold peaceful demonstrations, and claimed the group would wait for a week before announcing its next course of action.

“June 6, 2026, will be written in history because today the politics of this country has completely changed,” Ranka said, adding that many young people who were often discouraged from taking to the streets had come together for a peaceful demonstration.

The organisers repeatedly projected the protest as a youth-led campaign and sought to frame it as a response to concerns surrounding the education system.

“The time has come to reset our education system, and we have started that reset today,” Ranka said. “Until this education minister is there, we will not be able to improve the education system of this country,” he said.

While maintaining that the resignation demand remained the top priority, Ranka indicated that the campaign would continue beyond that issue.

“This is just the beginning. There are so many problems of the youth of this country,” he said, arguing that concerns relating to education had not received adequate attention.

Asked whether the mobilisation should be viewed as a protest, a movement or a political platform, Ranka described it as “a platform for the youth,” “a collective for the youth” and “a movement for the youth”, while leaving open how it may evolve in the future. The organisers also rejected suggestions that the mobilisation was linked to any established political formation and described themselves as “pro-youth, pro-education, pro-Constitution and pro-India”.

Ranka claimed the turnout had exceeded expectations and emphasised that the gathering remained peaceful despite the crowds.

“The Gen Z and the youth of this country have Gandhi and

Ambedkar in their blood,” he added, thanking participants who had travelled from different parts of the country to attend the event.

Saurav Das said people from several states, including Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Maharashtra, Bihar, Chhattisgarh and those in the Northeast, had joined the protest.

He also referred to online support for the campaign, claiming that hundreds of thousands of people had signed petitions seeking the minister’s resignation. “The youth wants to talk, but when the government is not talking, that is when they are getting on the road,” Das said.

He also thanked Delhi Police for facilitating the demonstration and said maintaining peace had been a priority for the organisers. “We are very happy that the Delhi Police’s priority was peaceful demonstration,” he said.

When Dipke reached Jantar Mantar, there was no stage and no proper public announcement system in place. He sat on the ground and tried addressing supporters through a feeble sound system, while content creators continued to exploit the moment in small and large groups across different corners of Jantar Mantar.

By noon, an impromptu stage had been set up. CJP supporters literally climbed the barricades to hold the backdrop in place. Dipke’s supporters lifted him onto their shoulders and carried him to the stage. As he approached it, he waved at the crowd with Babasaheb Ambedkar’s book in one hand. A series of speeches soon followed.

Notably, the Delhi Police was in a different avatar. Officers remained polite with protesters. Announcements urging the Gen Z crowd to move towards designated areas and maintain order were made in English. Materials for the stage, speakers, flex boards and banners were not obstructed either.

Among the political parties, the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) president Nitin Nabin, addressing a meeting in Ranchi, took a veiled swipe at Dipke, saying “some people sitting abroad think they will give direction to India’s youngsters”.

“India’s youngsters live in the village square with the farmer, live in coaching institutes, live on college campuses. But India’s youngsters are not going to move forward by becoming a puppet in the fist of a few people sitting in Delhi,” he said.

The main Opposition Congress party maintained a distance from the Cockroach protest and the social media movement. Supriya Shrinete, Congress’ senior media and communications strategist, made a veiled attack on Dipke and the CJP. She questioned how a certain set of protesters appeared to receive facilitation during the protest while the NSUI had faced hurdles during its agitation over paper leaks. She also reminded people that Rahul Gandhi has consistently stood with Gen Z on such issues.

Aam Aadmi Party chief Arvind Kejriwal has openly backed the CJP movement, describing it as an expression of the huge anger and frustration experienced by the youth of the country.

SEVERAL PEOPLE ALSO INJURED

Punjab: 9 killed after pick-up vehicle collides with truck

OUR CORRESPONDENT

FEROZEPUR: Nine people were killed, and several others were injured when a pick-up vehicle, in which they were travelling, collided with a truck near Janga Wala Mour on the Ferozepur-Fazilka road on Saturday.

As many as 32 persons, including women and children, were going from Jalalabad to Beas in Amritsar to immerse the ashes of a relative in the Beas river, when their vehicle met with an accident.

Many of them died on the spot, and the severely injured were brought to the Civil Hospital in Ferozepur.

Nikhil Gupta, Senior Medical Officer, said that those who were in critical condition have been referred to Guru Gobind Singh Government Medical College in Faridkot.

Ferozepur Senior Superin-



People gather near the wreckage after an alleged collision, in Ferozepur district, Saturday

PTI

tendent of Police Bhupinder Singh, along with other senior officials, reached the spot.

The SSP said the police were investigating to ascertain the exact cause of the accident.

Anshpreet Singh (12), who survived the accident with minor injuries, said that he was going with his family members to immerse the remains of his grandmother, Pooro Bai (62).

“We started our journey early at 3.30 am. Everything was normal, and we even stopped for fuel. As soon as we reached near Janga Wala Mour, the accident happened”, Anshpreet said.

The deceased were identified as Karnail Singh, Lakshmi Rani, Sukhwinder Kaur, Bhago Rani, Maya Bai, Surinder Singh, Raj Kumar, Darshan Singh and Vidya Rani.

PM expresses grief, announces ex gratia

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday expressed grief over the loss of lives in an accident in Punjab and announced an ex gratia of Rs 2 lakh to the next of kin of each deceased and Rs 50,000 for the injured.

“Deeply pained to hear about a mishap in Ferozepur district, Punjab. My condolences to those who have lost their loved ones. Wishing a speedy recovery to the injured,” Modi said in a post on X.

CM Sai listens to villagers from traditional cot, warns errant officials

OUR CORRESPONDENT

RAIPUR: In a rare and deeply human moment of grassroots governance under the ongoing Sushasan Tihar, Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai on Saturday held interaction with people in Nimdha village of Marwahi development block, seated on a traditional cot beneath the shade of a mango tree.

Far removed from formal conference halls and administrative chambers, Chief Minister engaged directly with villagers, listened to their concerns and sought first hand feedback on the actual implementation of government schemes at the ground level.

He held detailed discus-



Chief Minister Vishu Deo Sai MPOST

sions on essential public services, including electricity, drinking water, ration distribution, roads, healthcare, education and housing.

Addressing the gathering, Sai said the state-wide Sushasan Tihar, being observed

from May 1 to June 10, is aimed at ensuring that governance reaches people at their doorsteps.

He said complaints that could be resolved immediately were being addressed on the spot, while all other issues would be resolved within a fixed timeline.

During the chaupal, villagers along with Marwahi MLA Pranav Kumar Marpachchi demanded the establishment of a nursing college in the district, a mini stadium in Nimdha village and a large community Mangal Bhavan for all sections of society. R

especting public sentiment, Chief Minister Sai immediately approved and announced all three demands.

Army officer dies after falling into gorge in Rajouri

JAMMU: An army officer died after slipping in a mountainous area and falling into a deep gorge during an anti-terror operation in Jammu and Kashmir's Rajouri district on Saturday evening, officials said.

The officer, a lieutenant, was part of the security forces engaged in Operation Sheruwali, which entered its 15th day.

Operation Sheruwali is underway in the Dorimaal and Gambhir Mughalan belt to track down two to three Pakistani terrorists believed to be hiding in the forests of Rajouri district.

MPOST

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Saturday called upon citizens, particularly the youth, to contribute towards building self-reliant villages, empowering young people and ensuring prosperity for farmers, stating that the vision of a Developed India can only be realised through the development of rural India.

Addressing the annual foundation day celebrations of the Seva Sadhana and Gram Vikas Kendra at Samalkha in Panipat district as the Chief Guest, the Chief Minister described the institution as a living model of self-reliant



India and praised its efforts to transform rural communities through service, skill development, education, agriculture and social empowerment.

Congratulating the thousands of families associated with the initiative, Saini said the institution represents a powerful example of collec-

tive social commitment. When society itself resolves to drive its own development, transformation is not merely visible, it continues across generations, he said.

Highlighting Prime Minister, Narendra Modi's vision of a Developed India, the Chief Minister said villages form the strongest foundation of the nation's growth story.

He further said that the centre's focus on the holistic development of nearly 100 surrounding villages reflects a long-term commitment to strengthening education, healthcare, agriculture, sports, culture, employment and skill development in rural areas.

NARESH BISWANI

AGARTALA: A top-tier review session on border oversight unfolded under the leadership of Union Home and Cooperation Minister Amit Shah on Thursday. The discussion underscored territorial protection as central to reinforcing safety across the frontier shared by India and Bangladesh.

Emphasis emerged on unified planning rather than fragmented efforts when addressing regional vigilance. Strategic coordination stood out as pivotal throughout the dialogue. Consideration was given to layered methods for sustained boundary integrity. Attention shifted toward long-term readiness instead of short-term fixes.

‘India is Nepal’s most important partner’

NEW DELHI: India and Nepal share a “special” relationship and there is an opportunity to “decisively” shift the engagement to realise its full potential, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said on Saturday during a meeting with his Nepalese counterpart Shishir Khanal.

Khanal kicked off a three-day trip to New Delhi on Friday to strengthen bilateral ties, a visit overshadowed by a raging controversy triggered by Nepalese Prime Minister Balendra Shah's recent remarks on the boundary row between the two sides.

In his comments at the meeting with Jaishankar, Khanal said Nepal accords “highest priority” to its relationship with India and the Shah-led government is ready to engage “substantively and purposefully” with New Delhi.

“We carry no old baggage and have only firm resolve for a genuinely transformative relationship with our close neighbour and the most important partner,” he said.

MPOST

CBSE OSM ROW Pradhan’s continuation in office insult to lakhs of students: Cong

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Congress on Saturday said Education minister Dharmendra Pradhan must take responsibility for the lapses in CBSE on-screen marking (OSM), calling his continuation in office an insult to lakhs of students and their families.

Pradhan's continuation in office only speaks of his desire for power, the Congress remarked and accused him of being “incompetent” in running a “compromised ministry”.

In a post on X, Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh said after weeks of denying any wrongdoing and claiming that all is well with its COEMPT's On Mark portal, the CBSE has finally been forced to acknowledge COEMPT's incompetence.

He cited media reports in this regard that claimed that after initial denial, the CBSE invited an ethical hacker to plug gaps in the IT system.

“It began with a pub-

Closer Look

» ‘The skeletons in the Education Ministry’s closet are tumbling out fast and furious’

» ‘Pradhan’s continuation in office only speaks of his desire for power’

lic acknowledgment of the data breach (months after the cybersecurity vulnerabilities were reported by 19-year-old Nisarga Adhikary), and has now become even more painfully clear, as reports emerge that the CBSE has built its own in-house platform for the Grade 12 Board Exam re-evaluation process, using inputs from IIT experts and Nisarga himself,” he said.

“The Mantri Pradhan must take responsibility for these lapses. They have occurred on his watch, either through his active involvement, or through his own incompetence and hands-off attitude to gover-

nance. Either way, his continuation in office is an insult to lakhs of students and their families,” Ramesh said in his post.

In another post on X, Ramesh said that had the education ministry shown more integrity in organising the CBSE exams, the entire debacle that stressed lakhs of students across the country could have been avoided.

“The skeletons in the Education Ministry’s closet are tumbling out fast and furious,” Ramesh said in his post while citing media reports that COEMPT submitted two cybersecurity certificates to CBSE to satisfy the tender's cybersecurity requirements.

“It is now reported that both these certificates were tied to other clients. One of them had expired (it was nearly two years old when submitted by COEMPT) and the other was audited as a temporary application rather than as an application in a production environment.

TN: 4 former AIADMK ministers join TVK

OUR CORRESPONDENT

CHENNAI: In yet another setback for the AIADMK, which faces a severe internal crisis, the party's four former ministers and ex-MLAs have joined ruling TVK at its headquarters here on Saturday.

The AIADMK leaders who joined TVK include Udumalai K Radhakrishnan, M C Sampath, Kadambur C Raju and N R Sivapathi. All of them joined the ruling party in front of TVK General Secretary N Anand and General Secretary for election campaign management Aadhav Arjuna. Similarly, Ex-MP A Ilavarasan also joined TVK.

Seven former AIADMK MLAs -- Sundarraj, Rajamuthu, Manraj, Rajavarman Pannearselvam, M. Murugan and N Siva -- have also joined TVK. Similarly, two former DMK MLAs -- P Kamaraj and M S Shanmugam -- have also joined the ruling party.

TVK sources further said that more than 2,500 individuals, including office bearers at the state, district, town, ward, block-units and different wings of AIADMK and DMK, joined TVK as members.

After the April 23 poll debacle, the AIADMK is facing a series of setbacks.

First, a rebel group of 25 MLAs supported a motion of confidence moved by CM C Joseph Vijay on the floor of the Assembly on May 13, violating the party whip to vote against the motion.

‘Processing time for labour welfare schemes reduced from 203 to 73 days’

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Saturday announced a massive enrolment drive to register and revalidate 10 lakh construction workers free of cost across Punjab, while directing officials to take welfare schemes directly to labourers through special camps in villages and urban areas.

Chairing a review meeting of the Punjab Building and Other Construction Workers' (BOCW) Welfare Board, the Chief Minister said the Punjab government is committed to ensuring that every construction worker receives social security benefits, welfare assis-



tance and opportunities for skill development.

During this, CM Mann stated, “The Punjab Building and Other Construction Workers' Welfare Board has been formed to ensure the welfare, social security and socio-economic upliftment of construction workers through registration, financial assistance and implementation of welfare schemes. It is unfortunate that despite the availability of ample funds, welfare

schemes for labourers have not achieved the desired success due to long processing times.”

Highlighting the need to expand the coverage of welfare schemes, the CM noted, “As of now, 2.21 lakh workers are registered with the BOCW Welfare Board, which is quite low considering the massive construction activities and urbanisation taking place across Punjab. To improve registrations, more registration camps will be organised across the state,” he said.

Mann announced that the Punjab government will remove the registration fee burden on workers during the special campaign to encourage maximum participation.

BJP bets on two sure wins, hints at third Rajya Sabha seat in MP

Vijayvargiya signals BJP may keep third-seat option open in RS polls

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: BJP candidates Tarun Chugh and Rajneesh Agrawal on Saturday filed their nominations for the upcoming Rajya Sabha elections from Madhya Pradesh.

The two leaders submitted their nomination papers at the MP Assembly in Bhopal in the presence of Chief Minister Mohan Yadav, Deputy CM Jagdish Devda, senior BJP leader and minister Kailash

Vijayvargiya, and other ministers and party functionaries.

Voting for the three Rajya Sabha seats from the state is scheduled for June 18, while the last date for filing nominations is June 8.

The BJP has fielded its national general secretary Chugh and Agrawal for the biennial elections.

The Congress has nominated former Lok Sabha MP Meenakshi Natarajan for the seat falling vacant following the retirement of senior leader Digvijaya Singh.



The other two retiring members are BJP's George Kurian and Sumer Singh Solanki.

In the 230-member Assembly, the BJP has 165 MLAs, while the Congress has 63. One seat is held by the Bharat Adivasi Party, and another is vacant following the disqualification of Congress MLA Rajendra Bharti from Datia.

On the basis of the current strength, the BJP is comfortably placed to win two seats, while the Congress is expected to secure one.

However, the Congress'

decision to field Natarajan has reportedly triggered discontent within the party, fueling speculation over possible cross-voting.

Senior BJP leader Kailash Vijayvargiya on Friday further fuelled speculation by saying that the party would make every effort to win if it decided to field a third candidate.

With its numerical advantage and the possibility of cross-voting, the BJP appears to be keeping the option of contesting—and potentially winning—all three Rajya Sabha seats from the state open.

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: Madhya Pradesh on Saturday sought to strengthen its economic engagement with Latin American and Caribbean (LAC) nations, with Chief Minister Mohan Yadav pitching the state as a preferred destination for investment, manufacturing and exports.

Addressing the inaugural session of the India-Latin America and Caribbean Trade and Investment Forum-2026 in Indore, Yadav said the state was rapidly emerging as a global investment and export hub, backed by stable policies, robust infrastructure and industry-friendly governance.

Inviting business delegates from the LAC region to invest in the state, he said Madhya Pradesh offers over 1.25 lakh acres of ready-to-use industrial land, a road network of more than five lakh kilometres and strong rail and air connectivity. He also announced plans to develop six major industrial corridors over the next five years to further strengthen logistics.

The Chief Minister said exports from Madhya Pradesh



Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav interacts with the delegation

MPOST

to Latin American and Caribbean countries reached Rs 3,835 crore during the 2025-26 financial year, registering a 19 per cent increase over the previous year.

Pharmaceuticals have been a key driver of this growth, alongside engineering products, plastics, agri-based products and industrial packaging. Yadav said trade ties with countries including Brazil, Mexico, Chile, Argentina, Peru, Colombia and the Dominican Republic were expanding steadily, opening new avenues for collaboration.

Highlighting the state's

industrial strengths, he said Indore and nearby Pithampur have emerged as major pharmaceutical manufacturing hubs supplying international markets, while Madhya Pradesh is also well-positioned to serve the automotive, engineering and clean energy sectors.

The forum, attended by trade representatives from 15 countries, also saw the launch of a dedicated digital platform and website aimed at promoting business and investment cooperation between India and the Latin American and Caribbean region.

Nation Briefs

AHMEDABAD POLICE CHIEF G S MALIK APPOINTED GUJARAT DGP

AHMEDABAD: Ahmedabad Police Commissioner Gyanender Singh Malik was appointed the new Director General of Police (DGP) of Gujarat on Saturday, officials said. According to a notification issued by the state home department, Malik, a 1993-batch IPS (Indian Police Service) officer, has been appointed to the vacant cadre post of Gujarat DGP. Malik served as the Ahmedabad city police chief before being elevated to the state's top police post. He has replaced in-charge DGP K L N Rao and will now head the Gujarat police force.

CONSTABLE ‘HANGS SELF’ ON BASKETBALL COURT IN UP’S ETAWAH

ETAWAH: A constable posted in the police lines here allegedly hanged himself from a pole on a basketball court on Saturday morning, police said. The deceased, Ajit Singh Yadav (40), was posted in the Etawah police lines and lived in a government accommodation within the campus. Civil Lines Station House Officer K K Mishra said Yadav's body was found hanging from a rope tied to a pole at the basketball ground in the police lines on Saturday morning. Upon receiving information, police reached the spot, brought down the body and sent it for post-mortem examination, he said. According to police, Yadav was a native of Kanpur Dehat district and had joined the force as a constable in 2005. His elder brother, Arvind Singh, is posted as a sub-inspector in Etawah.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Pankaj S/o** Sanjay Drall **R/o** VPO Tikri Kalan New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 8/26 U/S 333/115(2)/74/76/79/351(3)/3(5)/117 BNS & U/s 3(2)(va) SC/ST (POA) Act. PS: Baba Haridas Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Pankaj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Pankaj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Pankaj** accused of **FIR No. 8/26 U/S 333/115(2)/74/76/79/351(3)/3(5)/117 BNS & U/s 3(2)(va) SC/ST (POA) Act. PS: Baba Haridas Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Shivali Bansal
DP/7506/DW/2026 ASJ-02, Room No. 4, Ground Floor
(Court Matter) Dwarka, Delhi

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

No.: Jhansi/W/T/Tender General/138

Date: 05.06.2026

E-Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

Description of Work: Bina-Jhansi section-TSR(P)-4 Tkms in Lalitpur yard by manual means and Pre & Post BCM work at balance location in BINA-JHANSI section under ADEN/LAR Sub Division.

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENG-G-2026-138

Approx Cost ₹ 26508828.09

Earnest Money : ₹ 530200.00

Date of closing Tender: 29.06.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

Date of Completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 12 Months.

Tender on line can be submitted upto to 15:00 hrs on 29.06.2026. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in

North central railways

@CPRONCR

www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENG-G-HQ-2026-137

Description of work: Virangana Lakshmbai Jhansi - JHS/E- Provision of Swimming Pool in Sr. Institute Jhansi.

Approx Cost: ₹ 18423718.65

Earnest Money: ₹ 368500.00

Date of closing Tender: 30.06.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 12 Months

* Tender online can be submitted upto to 15:00 hrs on 30.06.2026 * For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in

North central railways

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www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SEE SECTION 84(I) BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURKSHA SANHITA
Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused Persons Namely **1.Pankaj Singh S/o** Ram Singh **R/o** Vill. Raghunath Pura, PS: Bhampur, Distt: Buxsar, Bihar. **2.Amit Singh S/o** Brij Kishor Singh **R/o** Vill. Morta, PS: Babu Dham, Madhuvan, Ghaziabad, UP. **3.Amrut S/o** Anil Kumar **R/o** Vill. Kinda, PS: Mukteshar, Distt: Nainital, U.K. **4.Ozoda S/o** Alshad R/o C-393, Gali No.10, Bhajanpura, Delhi. **5.Mozam W/o** Karan **R/o** Ward No. 07, Cinema wali Gali, 28 Foota Road, Vikash Nagar, Dehradun, U.K. **6.Divya Rahlla D/o** Pradeep Rahlla **R/o** near Vatika Park, Mahipalpur, Vasant Kunj, Delhi. **7.Sabrina D/o** Mohamad **R/o** Vill. Mulgram, PS: Montasar, Distt: Badwan, West Bengal, Manteswar Burdwan, West Bengal. **8.Moknchakra S/o** Gaffur Jhah **R/o** Bypass Road Mahipalpur, Delhi have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 205/2022 U/s 3/4/5/8 ITP Act.**, has been registered at **PS: Vasant Kunj North, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the aforesaid, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the aforesaid, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **1.Pankaj Singh 2.Amit Singh 3.Amrut 4.Ozoda 5.Mozam 6.Divya Rahlla 7.Sabrina 8.Moknchakra** of **FIR No. 205/2022 U/s 3/4/5/8 ITP Act.**, has been registered at **PS: Vasant Kunj North, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Animesh Kumar JMFC-02, Room No. 19
(Court Notice) Patiala House Court, New Delhi

Israeli airstrikes kill 9 including three members of Lebanese army

An airstrike on a vehicle on a road linking city of Nabatiyeh with town of Marjayoun killed a brigadier general, a captain and another soldier

BEIRUT: Israeli airstrikes on southern Lebanon on Saturday killed nine people, including three members of the Lebanese military, the Lebanese army and state media said, days after the two sides reached a new ceasefire deal.

An airstrike on a vehicle on a road linking the city of Nabatiyeh with the town of Marjayoun killed a brigadier general, a captain and another soldier, the army said, without immediately releasing their names.

Another airstrike on the southern village of Saksakiyah killed six people and wounded four, the state-run National News Agency said.

"The continued, deliberate, and repeated Israeli aggression against Lebanon, its people and



Another airstrike on the southern village of Saksakiyah killed six people and wounded four, the state-run National News Agency said

its army only strengthens our resolve, faith and determination," the army said in its statement.

It said Israel's attacks aim to thwart all efforts "to reach a solution that would restore stability, establish a comprehensive ceasefire and lead to the Israeli withdrawal from the occupied Lebanese territories."

The Israeli military confirmed hitting a vehicle and said the incident is being reviewed. The statement added that the vehicle was "moving suspiciously" toward

Israeli soldiers near the village of Kfar Tibnit, after the military received "concrete indications" that Hezbollah would direct fire toward Israeli soldiers from the same area.

The military said that it operates against Hezbollah and not against the Lebanese army.

Lebanon's President Joseph Aoun called the strike "a flagrant violation of Lebanese sovereignty and international law." He said it came in the context of "ongoing escalation that threatens stability and security in the south (of Lebanon), despite

Highlights

- » 'The continued, deliberate & repeated Israeli aggression against Lebanon, its people & its army only strengthens our resolve, faith & determination'
- » It said Israel's attacks aim to thwart all efforts "to reach a solution that would restore stability"
- » The Israeli military confirmed hitting a vehicle & said incident is being reviewed. The statement added that the vehicle was 'moving suspiciously' toward Israeli soldiers

Iran for opposing the latest ceasefire deal between the Lebanese government and Israel, saying their country should not be used by Tehran as a "bargaining chip" in its talks with Washington.

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi responded in a post on X on Saturday by saying that after Aoun's comments, "one would think it's Iran that has occupied a fifth of Lebanon, displaced a quarter of Lebanese and is bombing his country on a daily basis."

"Had Lebanon been a bargaining chip for Iran, we'd have a deal long ago. Save Lebanon from your real foe, Mr President," Araghchi said in reference to Israel.

The war began on March 2, when Hezbollah fired rockets at northern Israel, two days after Israel and the US began their attacks on Iran. Israel has since launched a ground invasion of Lebanon and carried out wide attacks that have displaced more than 1 million people.

Israeli troops have seized around a fifth of Lebanon, pushing further into the country's south than at any time since the end of Israel's 1982-2000 occupation. More than 3,500 people have been killed in Lebanon since the war began. The fighting has killed at least 29 Israeli soldiers and three civilians.

'Israeli troops kill 7-month-old baby in West Bank'



HEBRON: Israeli troops killed a 7-month-old Palestinian baby boy after firing at his parents' vehicle in the occupied West Bank, the Palestinian Health Ministry said. Sam Fahd Abu Hailkal was killed Friday evening, and his parents were wounded while driving in the Tel Rumeida area south of Hebron City, according to the ministry.

The official Palestinian news agency Wafa said the baby was critically wounded after being struck in the face by the same bullet that injured his mother. He later died of his injuries. His father, Fahd Abu Hailkal, a lecturer at Bethlehem University, was shot in the hand. They were travelling from Bethlehem to visit family in Hebron when soldiers opened fire.

The Israeli military said Friday soldiers shot at a vehicle that was perceived to be accelerating toward them in the Hebron area. It said the soldiers responded with single shots, wounding three Palestinians. An initial inquiry found that the wounded were uninvolved civilians & the situation is under review.

Ukraine targets St Petersburg after Putin rejects offer for direct talks

St Petersburg Governor Alexander Beglov advised the residents not to go outside and warned of possible disruptions to mobile internet service

ST PETERSBURG: Residents of St Petersburg were told not to leave their homes after a large-scale Ukrainian drone attack targeted Russia's second-largest city Saturday morning, underscoring Kyiv's growing ability to hit deep inside Russia.

The attack came a day after Russian President Vladimir Putin refused an offer to meet his Ukrainian counterpart.

St Petersburg Governor Alexander Beglov advised the residents not to go outside and warned of possible disruptions



A plume of black smoke is seen over port of St. Petersburg, Russia

to mobile internet service, while regional Gov. Alexander Drozdenko said 141 drones were shot down over the surrounding Leningrad region.

Russia's Defence Ministry said its air defences shot down 376 Ukrainian drones. "Last night, our drones covered a distance of about 1,000 kilometres to the St Petersburg region — to the enemy navy's arsenals and a base in Kronstadt," Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy wrote on X.

Although no casualties were immediately reported, the renewed attack on St Petersburg is the latest embarrassing blow to Putin's efforts to cast the conflict as a distant event that doesn't

point" in it. Thursday's letter, the first public message Zelenskyy has written directly to Putin since Russia sent troops into Ukraine in 2022, was a sweeping critique of the Russian leader's 26 years in power, as well as some taunts about his age. Responding to Putin's dismissal of the proposed meeting, Ukrainian Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha said Saturday that things would "only get worse for Russia."

"Failures will get more humiliating," he wrote on X, warning that there are "no safe places in Russia that can be exempt" from Ukrainian long-range attacks, and that the intensity of attacks "will continue to grow." With the front line barely moving as swarms of drones hinder advances, both sides have sought an edge by launching long-range strikes.

In Ukraine, one person was killed and three wounded overnight into Saturday in the Dnipropetrovsk region, as Russian forces struck three districts nearly 30 times with drones and artillery, regional head Oleksandr Hanzha said.

US Bill seeks to end H-1B route to green card

WASHINGTON: A hard-line Republican lawmaker has introduced a draft legislation in the US Congress seeking an overhaul of the H-1B visa programme, including ending its use as a pathway to permanent residency in the United States.

**ICICI Bank**

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Himanshu Jindal/ Sumon Jindal/ LBDEL00005225136	Prop 1: Part of Freehold Built Up Property Bearing No. 282, Entire Second Floor Without Roof/Terrace Rights, Pocket 4, Sector 22, Situated At Rohini Residential Scheme Rohini, Delhi- 110086 & Prop 2: Part of Freehold Built Up Property Bearing No. 283, Entire Second Floor Without Roof/Terrace Rights, Pocket 4, Sector 22, Situated At Rohini Residential Scheme Rohini, Delhi- 110086/ June 04, 2026	February 11, 2026 Rs. 34,25,340/-	Delhi NCR/ Sonipat

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: June 07, 2026 Place: Delhi NCR

Sincerely Authorised Officer, For ICICI Bank Ltd.

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1.	M/s. Ppa Overseas Pvt Ltd/ Parmjeet Singh/ Harneet Kaur/ Parmeet Singh/ 662651200008	Address-1: Residential Property Bearing Property No. A-46, Entire Second Floor Without Roof/ Terrace Rights, Measuring Area 100.00 Sq. Yrds i.e. 83.61 Sq. Mtrs. With The Proportionate Rights of The Land Under The Said Property, Situated At Amar Colony, Lajpat Nagar- Iv, New Delhi, 110024. Admeasuring An Area- 100.00 Sq. Yrds i.e. 83.61 Sq. Mtrs Bounded By: North: As Per Gift Deed South: As Per Gift Deed East: As Per Gift Deed West: As Per Gift Deed/ Address- 2: Industrial Built- Up Property Having Measuring Area 91.00 Sq. Yrds i.e. 76.08 Sq. Mtrs. Property No. 487/1, Built on Part of Plot No. 01 In Block- 08, Out of Khosra No.420/214, 215, 217, 300, 299, 267, 218, 301, Situated At Village Jhilmil Tahripur, In The Abadi of Dilshad Garden, Illoaga Shahdara, Delhi- 110095. Admeasuring An Area- 91.00 Sq. Yrds i.e. 76.08 Sq. Mtrs Bounded By: North: Part of Property No.487/1 South: Road 25 Feet Wide East: Property of Others West: Road 30 Feet Wide/ Address- 3: Commercial Property Ground Floor Portion of Property Private No. 1579/B, Being Part of Property Bearing Municipal No. 1579 To 1585, Having Its Area Measuring 970.00 Sq. Feet or 90.15 Sq. Mtrs. Without Its Terrace/roof Rights, Situated At Ward No.01, Church Road, Kashmir Gate, Delhi- 110006. Admeasuring An Area- 970.00 Sq. Feet or 90.15 Sq. Mtrs. Bounded By: North: Gali/ Street South: Other's Property East: Part of Property West: Other's Property/ Date of Symbolic Notice June 04, 2026	November 11, 2025 Rs. 7,20,67,605.71/-	Delhi, New Delhi

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: June 07, 2026 Place: New Delhi

Sincerely Authorised Officer, For ICICI Bank Ltd.

**ICICI Bank**

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1.	M/s. A.T. Gold Enterprises/ Arsh Mohammad/ Mohammad Samar/ 6634055500482	Residential Freehold Built-up Property Bearing No.8224-27, Second Floor & Third Floor With Roof Rights, Measuring Area-72.00 Sq. Yrds. With Wide Release Deed No.3715 Dated 28/06/2007, Situated At Chinni Mill, M.M. Road, Bara Hindu Rao, Delhi- 110006, owned by Mohammad Samar, Admeasuring an area of 72.00 Sq. Yrds North: As Per Sale Deed, South: As Per Sale Deed, East: As Per Sale Deed, West: As Per Sale Deed/ Date of Symbolic Notice June 04, 2026	December 19, 2025 Rs. 1,01,11,098,77/-	Delhi

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: June 07, 2026 Place: Delhi

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The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: June 07, 2026 Place: Delhi NCR

Sincerely Authorised Officer, For ICICI Bank Ltd.

in the US for a limited period after graduation.

"For its nearly forty-year history, the H-1B visa has been abused, allowing employers to routinely sideline American STEM workers in favour of cheap foreign labour, while masking layoffs and wage suppression as 'shortages'."

"It's time to end this lottery-based pipeline and replace it with a system that prioritises merit, enforces real wage standards, and puts American white-collar workers first," said Roy, who represents the 21st district of Texas in Congress.

The bill is backed by US Tech Workers, the Immigration Accountability Project, and the Federation for American Immigration Reform. The legislation comes amid the Trump administration's crackdown on legal migration programmes through tightening restrictions, prioritisation of higher wages for H-1B applicants, and imposition of a \$1,00,000 fee on new petitions.

Beyond ending a pathway

to permanent residency, the bill seeks to impose sweeping changes to how the H-1B visa programme operates.

The legislation would require H-1B applicants to demonstrate that they maintain a residence abroad and do not intend to abandon it, reversing the longstanding policy of so-called "dual intent," under which visa holders can pursue permanent residency while working in the US.

It would also repeal provisions that currently allow H-1B holders to extend their status while awaiting green card processing.

The bill would shorten the maximum duration of an H-1B visa from six years to two years, while prioritising applications offering higher salaries rather than allocating visas through the existing lottery system.

"The bill will effectively address many of the egregious aspects of the H-1B visa programme," Kevin Lynn, President, US Tech Workers, said in a statement.

CLAIM HER FIRST GRAND SLAM

Mirraculous! Andreeva crowned new queen of French Open

CLAIM HER FIRST GRAND SLAM

Mirra Andreeva poses with the trophy with her coach Conchita Martinez AP

Chwalinska was attempting to become the first qualifier to capture the Roland Garros title.

When Andreeva executed a backhand cross-court winner on her first match point, she released her racket and dropped down onto the clay on her knees to celebrate as she covered her face with her hands. During the trophy presentation, Andreeva took the unusual step of thanking herself "for believing in myself, always giving my 100%, even when it's tough, trying every day to be better as a person and as a player, believing that I can do this, fighting so many demons inside of me."

Andreeva also thanked her

Future perfect? Shreyas Iyer to lead India's T20 side

"We've seen what he's (Shreyas) done over the last few years, leading different franchises," chairman of selectors Ajit Agarkar said. "He won the IPL once and has experienced every possible challenge as a captain. His own performances have been really good. In my opinion, he was the standout candidate with enough experience now."

The biggest talking point remains the rise of Shreyas Iyer. Despite being overlooked for two T20 World Cups, the Mumbai batter has forced his way back through consistent IPL performances. He led Kolkata Knight Riders to the IPL title in 2024 and has since been

And address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.	www.ireps.gov.in	
No: 128-W/269/O.E.T/NIT No. 04 (A B C D E F)/26-27/WE Dated :- 05.06.2026		1945/2026

Sd/- Sh. Jogender Singh



AS SHIFTING US PRIORITIES, CHINA’S GROWING INFLUENCE, AND ECONOMIC REALITIES RESHAPE THE INDO-PACIFIC, QUESTIONS ARE EMERGING ABOUT THE FUTURE RELEVANCE AND STRATEGIC DIRECTION OF THE QUAD

AUTHOR



DIPANKAR DE

At the Edge of Relevance

The Foreign Ministers of Australia, India, and Japan, and the Secretary of State of the United States of America, met in New Delhi on 26 May 2026 for the much-awaited Quad Foreign Ministers’ Meeting hosted by India to affirm their support for ‘a free and open Indo-Pacific’ that allows countries to develop resilience and strengthen capacity to determine their own paths. The Quadrilateral Security Dialogue (Quad) partners reiterated their commitments to working with regional partners to address a wide-ranging geo-political challenges through tangible initiatives focused on the four key pillars of Quad: maritime and transnational security, economic prosperity and security, critical and emerging technologies, and humanitarian assistance and emergency response.

The four partner countries of Quad, established in 2007, announced new initiatives on maritime surveillance, critical mineral supply chains, and energy security. In a statement, the Quad foreign ministers also said they “remain seriously concerned about the situation” in the disputed South China Sea and the East China Sea. “We reiterate our strong opposition to any destabilising or unilateral actions, including by force or coercion that threaten peace and stability in the region,” they added. The foreign ministers of the Quad grouping agreed to jointly build a port in Fiji and signed pacts covering critical minerals and energy security. The initiative could be significant for Japan after China halted shipments of some minerals used in aerospace, defence, and semiconductor industries following a diplomatic dispute.

China strongly criticised the Quad alliance, warning the group against targeting other countries. Reacting to the Quad’s meet, Chinese Foreign Ministry spokeswoman Mao Ning told a news briefing, “We do not support exclusive ‘small circles’ or bloc confrontation, and no cooperation should undermine mutual trust and cooperation among countries in the region. We have always believed that cooperation between countries should

help promote regional peace, stability, and prosperity and should not target any third party,” she added.

WANING SIGNIFICANCE OF QUAD

The origins of Quad 1.0 lie in the devastating 2004 Indian Ocean tsunami, when the four countries formed the “Tsunami Core Group” to coordinate the emergency response and humanitarian assistance. In the subsequent years, there were efforts to institutionalise the Quad, spearheaded by Abe Shinzo during his first term as prime minister of Japan from 2006 to 2007. Abe’s rationale for the Quad was to defend the international rules-based order, implying that China had become a threat to that order. Beijing, too, perceived it as an initiative aimed at containing its rise. It quickly sent formal notes of concern to the four foreign ministries in 2007. Beijing argued that the Quad forms part of a U.S.-led effort of “containment and suppression” and worries an “Indo-Pacific North Atlantic Treaty Organisation” will emerge.

THE G2 FEAR

The idea of a “G2” — a world order dominated by the United States and China — is increasingly unsettling America’s traditional partners in the Indo-Pacific. If Washington and Beijing choose to manage global issues through direct engagement and accommodation, countries such as Japan, India, and Australia could find their strategic influence diminished. Japan, in particular, worries that a closer US-China relationship may weaken long-standing security commitments and alter the regional balance of power. For India, a G2 framework could reduce the importance of multilateral groupings such as the Quad, forcing New Delhi to recalibrate its diplomatic and strategic priorities.

Initially, the Quad meetings were restricted to a Ministerial dialogue. Only in 2021 was it upgraded to Quad Summit. The 2025 Summit was scheduled in India, which got cancelled as the four-nation group had lost some momentum last year after failing to hold a leaders’ summit, amid tensions between U.S. President Donald Trump and Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi over Washington’s tariffs and other matters. While the four Foreign Ministers did not address the press directly after the New Delhi meet, as has been the convention, the Ministry of External Affairs, the Australian Minister, and the Japanese Foreign Ministry each held separate briefings during the day, refuting questions on whether the Quad had lost some of its importance and whether leaders of the grouping were now engaging more with other multilateral formations. As no specific date has been announced for the next Quad Summit, there is speculation that the Quad will be downgraded to a Foreign Minister-level meet or occur on the sidelines of other gatherings.

After the George W. Bush presidency, which was centered on the war in Iraq and the Middle East, the Obama administration launched what it called a “pivot” to Asia in 2011, with the aim of developing stronger military, diplomatic, and economic ties with the region. As part of the pivot, the Obama White House deepened engagement with the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN). The administration also upgraded alliances with South Korea, Japan, and Australia, and created a much closer partnership with Vietnam. It planned to join the Trans-Pacific Partnership (TPP), a massive, region-wide trade deal, though the U.S. ultimately did not join the TPP.

During the first Donald Trump administration, the policymakers revived the largely dormant Quadrilateral Security Dialogue (Quad). The Trump administration, along with its partners, turned the Quad into a productive forum for regional strategic dialogue. The White House also, in its National Security Strategy, clearly viewed China as a competitor, saying that Beijing was attempting to “displace the United States in the Indo-Pacific region, expand the reaches of its state-driven economic model, and reorder the region in its favour.” The Trump Administration imposed export controls on sending a wide range of high-technology items to China. It also deepened ties to India, with Trump hosting Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi at a boisterous gathering in Texas.

When Joe Biden became president, his administration maintained—and even hardened—some of Trump’s policies toward China, while deepening ties to Pacific partners in other ways. Indeed, Biden toughened export controls and also built close defence ties with the Philippines, a key U.S. ally in the region. Biden also publicly announced that the United States would defend Taiwan in the event of a Chinese invasion, a major statement.

However, the second Trump administration, since January 2025, seems ready to abandon what had been a bipartisan approach to the Indo-Pacific. The recent National Security Strategy (NSS), released in November 2025, makes clear that the White House’s top priority is maintaining U.S. dominance of the Western Hemisphere, and spends relatively little time talking about the strategic importance of the Indo-Pacific. The Pentagon’s 2026 National Defence Strategy (NDS) also no longer views China as a top security

THE QUAD’S LATEST MEETING IN NEW DELHI REAFFIRMED *commitments* TO A FREE AND OPEN INDO-PACIFIC, BUT BENEATH THE DIPLOMATIC RHETORIC LIE DEEPER UNCERTAINTIES

priority. The Trump administration has further cast doubt on the reliability of its defence relationships with some of its closest partners in Asia, such as Japan. Further, despite close ties in his first administration, the second Trump administration has seen a rapid downgrade of links with India, a major regional player and one that multiple administrations had cultivated.

Speaking at a major international security forum, the Shangri-La Dialogue in Singapore on May 30, U.S. Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth delivered a blunt message to America’s allies, declaring that the era of “freeloading” on U.S. military power is over. Hegseth urged partners across the Indo-Pacific and beyond to take greater responsibility for their own defence and increase military spending.

The United States began shifting its armada from the Asia Pacific to the Middle East at the outset of its war on Iran alongside Israel in February. During Epic Fury — the US military operation launched on February 28 against Iran — US forces spent more than half of their pre-war stockpile of four critical munitions. Meanwhile, the rapprochement between Trump and his Chinese counterpart, Xi Jinping, marked by a growing reconciliation between the two powers through trade deals, and the first visit by a US president to China in nearly a decade, a few weeks before the Delhi Quad meet, have rattled Quad countries, raising questions over its future.

G2: A TWO-POWER STRUCTURE LED BY THE USA AND CHINA

Donald Trump floated the “G2” concept at a US-China summit in South Korea in October 2025. Japan fears that a closer US-China relationship could sideline Tokyo and upset Asia’s security balance, especially

if Trump makes concessions on issues including Taiwan. On May 14, the summit between US President Donald Trump and Chinese President Xi Jinping in Beijing, Trump’s references to a “G2”—a two-power structure led by the United States and China, and his notably conciliatory tone toward Xi, made Japan visibly anxious. Chief Cabinet Secretary Minoru Kihara said at a press conference the same day: “We believe it is important that US-China relations contribute to the stability of the international community, including Japan, and we are closely monitoring the situation with great interest.”

For decades, Japan has relied on the cohesion of its alliance with the US to counter China, which has been expanding its maritime presence in the East and South China Seas and adopting an increasingly hegemonic posture. Now, Tokyo is worried about increased Chinese military activity in the Indo-Pacific, including the East China Sea and the Taiwan Strait. To Japanese defence strategists, Beijing is ranked as the top national security threat above North Korea and Russia since 2019.

Another significant shift in the USA’s Indo-Pacific policy is the indirect recognition of China’s territorial rights on Taiwan. In an interview in Beijing with Fox News, following the China-US summit, President Trump, when discussing the Taiwan question, said, “I’m not looking to have somebody go independent ... we’re not looking to have somebody say, let’s go independent because the United States is backing us.” He also stressed the distance involved, claiming that he was not looking for the US to travel 9,500 miles to fight a war. The US President Trump’s warning against “Taiwan independence” has sent shockwaves through Taiwan’s political circles. While pro-Democratic Progressive Party (DPP) outlets have largely attempted to downplay the remarks, a vice chairman of the Kuomintang (KMT) characterised the speech as a severe blow to the DPP.

As a strategic retreat from the Indo-Pacific region, it appears that the USA has dumped its long-trusted allies — Japan and India. Although the India-Japan Comprehensive Economic Partnership (CEPA) Agreement came into effect on 1 August 2011, in 2025-26 India’s trade with Japan hovered around USD 27.5 billion compared to a record USD 151.1 billion with China. India’s imports from China stood at USD 131.63 billion, while exports rose to USD 19.47 billion. Japanese FDI in India remains small compared to Japan’s total outward FDI. Japanese outward FDI to India in 2023-24 and 2024-25 stood at USD 3.1 billion and USD 2.48 billion, respectively, with USD 3.2 billion in 2025-26 (up to December 2025). Despite very cordial relations with Japan, India has failed to develop strong economic ties with the country.

Three East Asian major economies: China, Japan, and South Korea are members of the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership (RCEP) - the world’s largest trade bloc, which India decided to walk out of. Two other Quad members, Australia and Japan, are members of the China-backed RCEP. As the WTO has become almost defunct, India should consider joining this Indo-Pacific trade bloc and play a constructive role in shaping global trade policies in this fast-changing geopolitical game.





AS MG MOTORS GROWS ITS INDIAN CUSTOMER BASE WITH TECHNOLOGY-RICH VEHICLES, A BURNING QUESTION EMERGES: CAN INDIA REDEFINE GLOBAL AUTOMOTIVE PARTNERSHIPS?



After JSW Took the MG Wheel

AUTHOR



RAJEEV NARAYAN

A curious thing happens when an MG vehicle pulls up at a traffic signal. Nobody asks about its engine. Few are concerned with its BHP and torque figures. The conversation revolves around a different specification altogether: Where is it from? In an era when automobiles are turning into computers on wheels, consumers have realized that technology can excite but ownership structures can obscure. Few companies embody this contradiction more than MG Motor India.

The brand arrived carrying British heritage, Chinese ownership and global ambitions. It entered a market that was becoming nationalistic, security-conscious and wary of geopolitical dependencies. Yet, MG arrived just when Indian consumers were demanding exactly what it was offering: technology-rich vehicles packed with features, connectivity and digital experiences.

The result was an unusual contest. Not petrol versus electric. Not SUV versus sedan. But technology versus trust. MG cars touched Indian roads in 2019. Since then, the battle has evolved into something quite interesting.

DIGITAL DARLING

To understand MG's rise, one must acknowledge a simple truth: MG spotted India's technology appetite well before its rivals. When the Hector arrived in 2019, it was marketed as an 'Internet SUV' – a moniker that sounded almost futuristic. Yet, buyers embraced large touchscreens, connected-car features, voice commands and over-the-air capabilities with erectile enthusiasm. The Hector demonstrated that Indian consumers wanted more than mobility. They wanted real technology.

MG doubled down. Whether through advanced connectivity, premium cabin experiences, electric mobility or feature-rich interiors, the company built its identity around digital-first motoring. And its success in the electric vehicle space strengthened that proposition.



The Windsor EV emerged as one of India's defining electric vehicles, combining practicality, technology and value in a package that resonated with buyers. Suddenly, MG was not a challenger brand. It was shaping conversations around the future of mobility. Yet, this same success created a paradox. Consumers admired the products. The market rewarded innovation. But questions around ownership and geopolitical linkages never ceased.

CHINESE LINEAGE

For years, MG occupied a uniquely uncomfortable position. Its products were Indian in their appeal, but its association with China's SAIC Motor regularly overshadowed discussions about engineering, design or customer experience. Following the deterioration of India-China relations after the Galwan military skirmish, scrutiny of Chinese investments intensified across sectors, including automobiles.

The irony was impossible to ignore. Many of the technologies driving the global electric vehicle revolution – from battery chemistry and supply chains to vehicle architectures – were intertwined with Chinese capabilities. Even automakers publicly emphasising that localisation depended on Chinese suppliers somewhere in the value chain.

India's automotive industry found itself confronting a difficult reality. The future of mobility would require access to global technology, yet national sensitivities could not simply be brushed aside. MG became the visible face of that contradiction. And for a while, MG was caught between two worlds.

NEW INDIAN DRIVER

Today, the turnaround development at MG is not happening on the showroom floor, but in the boardroom. For years, the company's challenge was perception. Consumers admired the products but remained uncertain about the ownership story. That story is changing. JSW Group, one of India's most influential industrial conglomerates, is assuming a larger role in the venture and is expected to become its single-largest shareholder. What began as a partnership is looking like an Indian-led automotive enterprise with global technological foundations.

That distinction matters. JSW is not an auto newcomer making a speculative bet. The group has built businesses across steel, energy, infrastructure, cement, paints and education. It understands manufacturing scale, capital allocation and long-term nation-building. Under its stewardship, MG's strategy is focused on localisation, growth and relevance. The timing is significant too. India is entering a phase of automotive transformation where software, batteries, connectivity and artificial intelligence are becoming as important as engines and gearboxes. Success will depend on combining technological capability with local execution.

JSW'S CALL TO ACTION

JSW has recognised this. Its ambitions extend beyond MG. The group is building a wider automotive ecosystem,

including new SUV and premium vehicle programmes expected to leverage advanced Chinese technologies and platforms through strategic partnerships.

To some, that may appear contradictory. In reality, it is pragmatic. The world's auto industry has always thrived on collaboration. German brands source globally. Japanese firms partner globally. American manufacturers rely on worldwide supply chains. The future will belong not to those who isolate themselves from technology, but to those who can absorb it most effectively.

If MG and JSW can create synergies across product development, manufacturing, supply chains and future vehicle programmes, they may be constructing something more significant than a successful automotive brand. They may be creating a template for how India engages with global mobility technologies.

THAT NEW TEMPLATE

The debate around MG is no longer about whether Indian consumers will buy a Chinese-linked vehicle. The market has already answered that question. The real question is whether India can create a new automotive model; one where Indian capital, Indian management and Indian market understanding combine with the best technologies available anywhere in the world. That may ultimately be the real significance of JSW's intervention.

Rather than distancing itself from global technology, the group seems determined to harness, adapt and deploy it for Indian consumers. In an industry being reshaped by electrification, software and artificial intelligence, such pragmatism may prove more valuable than ideology.

The lesson extends far beyond cars. Nations do not become competitive by shutting off the innovation tap. They do so by building the confidence to shape, localise and improve. In today's world, horsepower matters. Software matters. Price matters. Yet, the most valuable feature is one that never appears on a brochure: Trust. And MG's story is becoming less about where the technology comes from, and more about who is steering the wheel.

THE MG STORY IS NO LONGER ABOUT CHINESE OWNERSHIP. IT IS BECOMING AN *acid test* FOR INDIA'S ABILITY TO COMBINE DOMESTIC LEADERSHIP WITH GLOBAL TECH

WELLNESS

HABITS OF THE MIND



Many emotional traits are learned habits; recognising them helps replace criticism with compassion and calm

AUTHOR



ERA DUTTA

THE SHIFT

None of these patterns are character flaws. They are learned adaptations. Often developed early in life for understandable reasons. But survival patterns that once protected you can later start exhausting you. The mind can be trained differently.

TRY THE CS THAT RESTORE YOU

COMPASSION
Especially self-compassion. Research by psychologist Kristin Neff shows self-compassion predicts wellbeing more reliably than self-esteem. Self-esteem depends on feeling successful or worthy. Self-compassion simply means treating yourself with basic humanity, even when struggling.

CALM

Not the absence of stress, but the ability to regulate your nervous system during stress. Calm is not a personality trait, it's a skill. Built through consistent practices that bring the body back to baseline: movement, breathing, silence, prayer, nature, sleep. Curate your own calm regularly.

THE CS THAT COST YOU

CRITICISM
Not healthy feedback. The constant inner voice that turns every mistake into proof that you are inadequate. Did you know that the brain reacts to harsh self-criticism almost like an external threat? Your nervous system releases stress hormones as though danger is present. Over time, this creates chronic psychological strain linked to anxiety, depression, and burnout. Many people live under attack from their own internal dialogue.

COMPARISON

Comparison has become a modern reflex. Usually happening late at night, through a glowing screen. The problem is not ambition; it is comparing your private struggles to someone else's edited highlights. Your uncertainty against their carefully curated confidence creates a competition designed for you to lose. For some, the competition within of the glory days that you once lived becomes a constant loop.

CATASTROPHISING

This is the mind's tendency to jump from uncertainty to disaster without stopping at realistic possibilities. The unanswered text becomes rejection, a headache becomes catastrophe and one difficult meeting becomes career collapse. Catastrophising confuses vivid imagination with accurate prediction. The mind starts suffering before anything has actually happened.

CONTROL

Often disguised as productivity or perfectionism. The need to control everything usually comes from anxiety. If everything is organised tightly enough, maybe nothing bad will happen. But the tighter the grip, the more exhausting life becomes. Small uncertainties start feeling dangerous and over time, the world feels narrower and the person inside it feels depleted.

CLUTTER

Not just physical clutter. Mental clutter. Unfinished decisions, avoided conversations. Emotions postponed indefinitely and background worries left unresolved. Psychologists describe something called the Zeigarnik effect: the brain repeatedly returns to unresolved issues. This creates a constant hum of tension that many people mistake for "just stress."

THERAPY, reflection and intentional change cannot erase struggle, but can foster healthier emotional responses

CURIOSITY

One of the most underrated psychological strengths. Curiosity changes the question from: "What is wrong with me?" to "What is happening here?" That shift moves the brain out of judgment and into understanding. A curious mind becomes more flexible, less defensive, and more resilient.

CONTENTMENT

This is different from happiness. Happiness often depends on circumstances. Contentment is the ability to remain grounded in what already exists, even when life is imperfect. It is less about having everything and more about being fully present with something.

CONNECTION

Possibly the most neglected one. Many people appear socially connected while feeling emotionally unknown. Genuine connection means being understood, not just seen. Strong human connection protects against anxiety, burnout, and emotional isolation more powerfully than most people realise. And unfortunately, the very habits that hurt us, anxiety, control, overwork, emotional clutter, are often the same habits that slowly disconnect us from others.

THE QUESTION WORTH ASKING YOURSELF

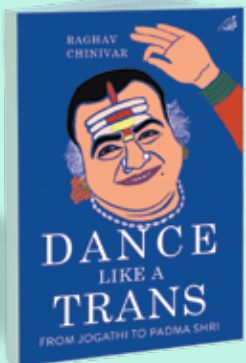
Which costly C is loudest in your life right now and which restorative C is missing? Because once you identify the pattern, you stop confusing it with your identity. Therapy, reflection, and intentional change cannot erase human struggle, but can help the mind stop retraining the default setting to a healthier one.

JÜRGEN HABERMAS (1919-2026)

A Philosopher as an Activist

Jürgen Habermas' life and work remind us that reason, memory and dissent remain essential safeguards against fascism, market arrogance and the moral decay of war

A JOURNEY OF RESILIENCE AND IDENTITY



PUBLISHER: **Niyogi Books**

Price: **Rs 595**

Dance Like a Trans: From Jogathi to Padma Shri by Raghuvar Chinnivar is much more than a biography. It chronicles the extraordinary life of Dr Mata B. Manjamma Jogathi, one of India's most celebrated transgender folk artistes, whose journey from social exclusion to receiving the Padma Shri mirrors a larger story of dignity, perseverance and cultural heritage. The book traces her transformation from Manjunath, a child struggling to express her identity in rural Karnataka, to a revered exponent of Jogathi Nritya and the first transgender president of the Karnataka Janapada Academy. Chinnivar presents a deeply human account of loss, faith, survival and artistic expression, while also documenting a tradition that remains little known outside southern India. Published by Niyogi Books under its Paper Missile imprint, the 290-page volume serves as both a personal memoir and an important record of India's transgender cultural history.



AUTHOR



SUBHORANJAN DASGUPTA

UNDOUBTEDLY, THE GREATEST SOCIAL AND POLITICAL PHILOSOPHER OF THE WEST, JÜRGEN HABERMAS, WHO PASSED AWAY RECENTLY (IN MID-MARCH), CONTINUES TO DRAW THE ADMIRING ATTENTION OF FELLOW ACADEMICS AND THE MEDIA. INDEED, HIS INFLUENCE AND IMPACT WILL CONTINUE TO REVERBERATE FOR LONG. BUT, ABOVE ALL, HE WAS A DEDICATED DISSENTER, AN ACTIVIST WHO CASTIGATED ALMOST EVERYTHING NEGATIVE, FROM THE FALSIFICATION OF HISTORY TO EGOTISTIC NEO-LIBERALISM AND IRRELEVANT, IMMORAL WARS. THE AUTHOR OF THIS PIECE, A RENOWNED ACADEMIC AND WRITER WHO INTERACTED WITH HIM, EXAMINES HIS ROLE IN THIS ARTICLE AS A SOCIAL CONSCIENCE AND TIRELESS PROTESTER.

Adolescent Jürgen simply could not escape it. His father, Ernst Habermas, a sworn Nazi, compelled his 15-year-old son to join the Hitler Youth Brigade. There he learnt to scream 'Hail Hitler' and even fire anti-aircraft guns to halt the irrepressible aerial advance of the Allied forces after the landing at Normandy. This existential experience with war turned him into a vocal pacifist and made him realise how pernicious and dispensable Fascism was. After the war ended, he began his studies as a student of philosophy and in early 1953 he challenged the metaphysical premise of the illustrious German philosopher, Martin Heidegger. When I asked him, "You were just a greenhorn then, why did you pick him as your adversary?" His answer was candid enough, "I shall never disregard the influence of Heidegger or Edmund Husserl, two philosophers who have influenced their next generation so impressively. But, how



can I ever forget that Heidegger endorsed the Third Reich, used it to advance his own career, and even after the war did not express a word of apology, knowing very well what those criminals had perpetrated." In this very context, Habermas came very close to the great German novelist, his friend, Günter Grass who literally lampooned Heidegger's discourse in his masterpiece *Dog Years*.

After crossing swords with Heidegger, Habermas joined the renowned Frankfurt Institute for Social Research, where he worked with the celebrated aesthete and thinker Theodor Adorno. His reverence for Adorno was deep but here, too, he rejected the thesis of his mentor and his partner, the equally prestigious Max Horkheimer, who in their classic *Dialectic of Enlightenment* (1947—an immediate post-war publication) had roundly concluded that the shattered world confronted hopeless negativity and redemptive Reason has eclipsed. When I raised this sensitive topic, he commented, "I have learnt a lot from both, Adorno in particular, but I reject his conclusion that dialectics terminates with negation. No, the entire dialectical tradition of Europe beginning from Immanuel Kant and right upto Karl Marx, in particular, stresses unequivocally that the ultimate synthesis of this process is the redemption of the human being and his society. Reason is inextricably attached to ethical regeneration, in spite of the virulent abuse it had been subjected to in the immediate past." Well, the vibrant protest continued; he voiced this trenchant



From Nazi Germany's shadow emerged one of Europe's strongest voices of conscience

“PERHAPS, I AM THE ONE AND ONLY MARXIST REMAINING IN THE WEST, BUT A PECULIAR MARXIST AT THAT”
— Jürgen Habermas

critique in 1956. This persisting strain exploded in the eighties of the last century when some pseudo-historians like Ernst Nolte and Michael Stürmer attempted vigorously to whitewash or dilute the criminality of the Nazi past. Known as the famous *Historikerstreit* or *Historians' Dispute*, this conflict thrust Habermas into the role of the corrective leader and he lambasted the apologists of Auschwitz and Belsen with unimpeachable evidence. Once again, he was ably assisted by Günter Grass, who wrote his stinging *Writing after Auschwitz* in this phase, where he declared, along with Habermas, that Nazism with its concentration camps served as the benchmark of their people's downfall and cruelty. Both Habermas and Grass used almost the same words to voice their bitter denunciation, "We simply cannot forget or evade our past, we need to remember the gas chambers every moment so that we do not repeat that calamity again. Our memory should function as our unerring guide." From this phase, Habermas turned into an uncompromising critic of aggressive neo-liberalism or the arrogant phase of unbridled market-domination. Again, he found his comrades-in-arms in Jacques Derrida, the illustrious French philosopher, and Günter Grass. Just recall their statements one by one and you will realise that they represented the 'Other' Europe determined to challenge the so-called prevailing common sense of Reagan, Thatcher, Bush and even Francis Fukuyama. No, the latter have not ensured the advent of any paradise in our earth, they stressed. Derrida, in his classic *For Marx* (1993) lashed out by saying, "For it must be cried

out, at a time when some have the audacity to neo-evangelise in the name of the ideal of a neo-liberal democracy that has finally realized itself as the ideal of human history: never have violence, inequality, exclusion, famine, and thus economic oppression affected as many human beings in the history of the earth and of humanity."

Grass, in his Nobel Prize Lecture delivered in 1999, castigated this new dimension of profit-crazy capitalism as 'megalomania'. He even warned that unless the atrocious North-South economic divide is removed, thousands of refugees will invade Fortress Europe because hunger tramples all barriers and borders.

Finally, Habermas, in a revealing interview given to Thomas Ashower in 2000, affirmed with a stern reminder, "Politics, and not capitalism, is responsible for promoting the common good. The whole programme of subordinating the lifeworld to the imperatives of the market must be subjected to scrutiny." Turning his attention to the developing world, victim of the most glaring deprivation, he added, "Viewed in global terms, this avenging fate is also afflicting more the economically weaker sections, countries and their people. That's the political scandal. The poor must be given adequate purchasing power, if needed, by a massive transfer of resources."

No doubt, this strident opposition to market-mania as the be-all and end-all led to wars where weapons could be used with impunity and the powerful arms industry could be kept in good cheer. Habermas pinpointed this aberration as "the legitimate crisis of capitalism which ignited wars." Accordingly, he, Derrida, Grass and other European dissidents condemned Bush Junior's war against Iraq with magisterial conviction. They pooled their resources together and published a scathing critique, *Old Europe, New Europe*. Core Europe, whose preface was written by Derrida and Habermas. They sought to construct a human alternative "to act as Uncle Sam's poodle and to throw the people at the mercy of warmongers, which is as dangerous as chaotic." (Habermas, in the same interview). The most apposite comment on his worldview and dissent was articulated by one of his best commentators, Philips Felsch. He confirmed, "Habermas never hesitated to label himself as a Socialist. And the more he experienced the misery of the world, the more he felt the need to come close to radical Leftists. His prescription was clear—we have to learn from them."

Our dialogue in a beer pub in the old town area of Heidelberg in 1986 on a warm, summer evening was drawing to an end, when he suddenly asked, "But you said you come from Kolkata. Which means you are a Bengali and Tagore is your greatest writer. Well, I am no literary critic, so I cannot comment on his poetry. But I have read his *Nationalism* thoroughly. It is just impeccable. What foresight, what humaneness, what implacable opposition to divisions of all kinds – race, colour, religion, language. This book by him should be prescribed as compulsory reading for all Political Science departments in all universities." The two-hour interaction concluded on this effusive note and as a Bengali and Indian, I felt mightily proud and elated.

AUTHOR



SANJEEV CHOPRA

A Toast to Fauji Humour

Combat Chuckles captures the wit, camaraderie and absurdities of military life through stories and poems that reveal the lighter side of life in uniform

Brig Rajendra Singh, SM, FRGS, and Col Ajay K. Raina established Sabre & Quill seven years ago as the publishing arm of the Military History Research Foundation (MHRF) to provide a platform for writers connected with the defence services, life in cantonments, and strategic scholarship in India. Their range of books is impressive — from battle victories to memoirs of veterans, translations of classics like the Arthashastra to horror mysteries, books on China, and the lesser-known heroes of 1857. To this vast repertoire, there is a new addition: *Combat Chuckles*, which deals with combat situations and incidents in cantonments, with the explicit aim of drawing chuckles as one goes through the fine selection of 21 short stories and three anecdotal poems. Compiled and edited by Dehradun-based author and educator Ratna Manucha, whose lifelong connection with the Army — first as a daughter and then as a spouse — equips her with all the right credentials, the book shares with readers the camaraderie and esprit de corps that make life in uniform not just bearable, but absolutely delectable.

Although I never donned a uniform (even though I cleared my SSB), I spent my formative years in the Jalandhar Cantonment. I also had the privilege of doing my Army attachment with the

7 Sikh Light in the Akhnur area, alongside later postings in the military stations of Kalimpong and Siliguri, besides the cities of Kolkata, New Delhi, and Dehradun, each of which has Army cantonments and golf courses. I have also had more than my share of 'Fauji' anecdotes from my father, uncles, cousins, and friends — many of whom are Army brats. So, when RM asked me to write a blurb for her book and also do a review, there was no question of not doing it.

Let us now get to the book. We begin with the poems, for they are only three in number — two of which are from RM herself. The first is 'Life in the Army', a sanitised and publishable version of what we heard in our growing-up years. The lines I liked best in this are: "Life in the Army/They say is one big joke,/But I have yet not started laughing/And the others too are long-faced blokes!"

In 'The Visit' of the GOC to a military station, everyone and everything obviously has to be perfect: "You see, the General is paying a visit/(other lesser mortals just 'pass through')/the barbers and tailors worked round the clock... everyone has to look fit/Doesn't matter if they have to squeeze into their 6 Bs, and slowly turn blue!"

Now for some of the stories — since a review is only a sampler — starting with 'Borderline Etiquette' by Lt Col Manoj Asthana, in which two adjacent border posts across the LoC looked



absolutely spick and span for their respective GOCs who were visiting. Then we have Brig Suyash Sharma's 'Topsy Pudding' — an ode to the mouth-watering concoction served to RIMC cadets. The pudding is a sponge cake immersed in fruit syrup as the base, topped with layers of fresh fruit, custard, jelly, fresh cream, and dry fruits, with each chef adding his or her own personal touch — crumbled Marie biscuits, tinned cherries, or jam. Mouth-watering descriptions indeed!

I now come to my favourite story, 'Military Jargon Goes Awry', by Wing Commander Anupama Joshi. But before I narrate its theme, a few words about her. Anupama was among the first batch of women to join the armed forces in 1992, and she went on to win the legal battle for parity with gentleman officers. The story

concerns a cryptic communication addressed to a 'dog-shooting squad' at an Air Force station in the western sector, where all attempts to chase away or castrate the strays had failed. A high-powered decision was taken to scare the four-legged intruders away from the fenced area with the use of rubber bullets, as they would often appear on the runway and thereby affect normal take-off and landing operations. However, due to a typographical error by the sergeant, the order read: "The following dogs are detailed to shoot the officers." After the choicest expletives had been hurled at the hapless sergeant, his quivering fingers typed out a fresh order that said: "Read officers for dogs, and dogs for officers."

This not only had me in splits, but also reminded me of one of my first lessons at the Times of India Training School four decades ago. We were told how typos can ruin both a story and a reputation. Thus, on account of a missing 'r', the obituary of a General read: "The battle-scarred veteran died peacefully in his sleep last night." But in the correction carried the next day, the 'a' in 'battle' became an 'o', and so the corrigendum ran as follows: "The bottle-scarred veteran died peacefully in his sleep last night."

In 'Orders Received, Thinking Deferred' by Brig Steve Ismail, we learn that, for the NCO, the instructions of the Subedar Major are akin to the commandments of the Lord. Because

they had been told to reach before the GOC, their Shaktiman truck refused to give way to the General's cavalcade, even when the pilot vehicle was blaring its siren to indicate that the VVIP was travelling in one of the Jongsas — the legendary rugged 4x4 vehicle manufactured in India specifically for the Indian Army from 1969 to 1999.

'Turbaned Tales' by Brigadier Preet Pal Singh narrates interesting anecdotes from his journeys across continents, where his turban became the most prominent part of his sartorial identity. He writes: "My turban all through has been a conversation starter, a royal diadem and often a magic prop. From being mistaken for an Arab sheikh, a Red Indian, to being quizzed about my helmet, I have lived by Khushwant Singh's dictat: 'A sardar abroad is never anonymous.'"

Then we have Col Avnish Sharma's take on military language. 'Clear as Camouflage' begins with him contesting the number of languages Indians speak, for, in addition to the 22 official languages, he has added the 23rd quasi-official language of military lingo. This is spoken by over two million people serving in the Indian Army, as well as by veterans. Some examples are wilco, roger, tiger, clot, bajri, et al. "You walk like a pregnant duck, pull up your socks, tighten your belt, get on the ball, move, you lazy bum, get lost" — these are part and parcel of every cadet's life, and they continue to haunt him or her long after leaving the services and heading towards the grave!

Last, but not least, is the poem 'If (Revisited)' by Col Shivaji Tanjan Ghosh, which offers deep philosophical insight: "If you can speak/and not feel depressed if others disagree;/If you can meet with those who became generals/and those who missed the boat/and treat both equally;" then, and only then, can it be said that you have lived your life like a true soldier. For you have taken the twist with the turn, the dusk with the morn, and the agony with the ecstasy.

THE GIANTS MISSING OUT



Italy
Four-time champions Italy have failed to qualify for a third successive World Cup, highlighting deep structural issues in one of football's most storied nations.



Nigeria
A traditional African powerhouse, Nigeria's absence once again raises questions about administration and long-term planning.



40 Days of Football Carnival

OPENING MATCH



MEXICO



SOUTH AFRICA

FRIDAY | 12 JUNE | 12:30 AM

AUTHOR



S KANNAN

A bigger, fatter FIFA World Cup starts on June 11, with the United States of America, Canada and Mexico as co-hosts, where uncertainty is the buzzword. For several reasons, one does not know what to expect this time, though what is felt in unison is that the action in 'The Beautiful Game' will be riveting.

From an Indian point of view, even though the sport at home languishes at the bottom, there is no dearth of football-crazy fans. In terms of popularity and ease of understanding, football is loved by people the world over. India is lucky that, finally, it will be telecast on Zee, something that had been delayed inordinately.

After the pulsating action in the Indian Premier League, where Royal Challengers Bengaluru (RCB) emerged champions, it is time for a change of flavour. Certainly, football will be consumed lavishly in the coming period, till July 19.

When one compares cricket with football, in India at least, the craze for the willow sport exceeds all limits. However, once the FIFA World Cup roars to life, all talk will

A 48-TEAM FORMAT, THREE HOST NATIONS, AGEING SUPERSTARS, EMERGING TALENTS AND GEOPOLITICAL TENSIONS COMBINE TO MAKE THE 2026 FIFA WORLD CUP ONE OF THE MOST UNPREDICTABLE TOURNAMENTS IN FOOTBALL HISTORY

along with Spain and Brazil, will dominate most data-driven predictions. Whether such forecasts hold true over a long tournament remains to be seen. France has been in the news for the wrong reasons, with PSG winning the UEFA Champions League title last Sunday in Paris against Arsenal. What followed was ugly, with hoodlums setting parts of Paris ablaze, including areas near the Eiffel Tower.

The World Cup is taking place at a time when there is turmoil across the globe. The Iran conflict has turned increasingly ugly, which is unfortunate. It hurts to see so much destruction in the region and neighbouring countries. Iran did qualify for the World Cup but still awaits visas to enter the USA, where it is scheduled to play important matches. As of now, what one hears is that Iran will be based in Mexico. There is every possibility that, given the lack of trust between America and Iran, the war-hit nation may face additional hurdles. How FIFA ensures Iran can play its matches in the USA will be interesting, of which visa issuance is only one aspect.

Viewed from a security angle, holding the World Cup in the USA will be challenging. Security concerns, logistics and high ticket prices — criticised even by locals in America — continue to make news. The number of venues earmarked for the FIFA World Cup is huge. Flying between cities will not be a problem for national teams. However, fans wishing to attend matches at multiple venues will face challenges. Airfares and hotel prices are extremely high. This is going to be a very different experience compared to Qatar in 2022. What will fans experience as 'new' in 2026? Certainly, the World Cup is not only about well-known names. One has already seen lesser-known players ready to make a mark. In a warm-up event, Haiti defeating New Zealand 4-0 was certainly surprising. For those who were critical of Qatar and Doha because of the restrictions, the USA, Canada and Mexico are likely to provide a far more open and festive atmosphere.

The American version of soccer is more popular than traditional football in the USA, but the fact that the country secured the rights to host this World Cup is significant. Preparations have been meticulous, but the real test will begin only when the World Cup roars into action. America last hosted the FIFA World Cup in 1994, when Brazil defeated Italy in a penalty shootout in Los Angeles. Can an energetic Brazil produce the same magic this time? That remains to be seen. This time, MetLife Stadium in East Rutherford, New Jersey, will host the final on July 19.

No story on World Cup football is complete without a mention of England. Harry Kane leads a side managed by Thomas Tuchel. They last won the World Cup in 1966, 60 years ago. As much as the English media goes gaga over every FIFA World Cup, England's performances have often fallen short of expectations. To do well in the USA, they are under intense scrutiny.

Olympics. So, for every team that has made the cut, it is an achievement. And for those who have missed out, notably former champions Italy, it is a time to mourn. Italy's football has been going downhill for a long period. Missing a third World Cup in a row is cause for consternation. Of course, the reasons for the slide are many, but they point to a system that has failed.

As winners of Euro 2020, Italy flattered to deceive. There is a bigger problem within their football system, one that can be solved only from within. Their Serie A has become less competitive and clubs increasingly look for cheap options. In addition, despite repeated calls for a revamp, nothing has worked. Italy failing to qualify once again is agonising for old-timers.

Just as Italy will be missed, so will Nigeria. The African nation failed to make the cut after losing out to Congo. This is the second successive World Cup Nigeria will miss, having also been absent in Qatar. The reasons include poor football administration at home, something that remains crucial. So, if one looks at the 48 teams that have come through to the main draw, they have done so after tough qualification campaigns.

Talk of European teams and France and England will be hyped. These two nations,

be of free-kicks, headers, offside decisions and penalties. Sample this: till the 2022 edition of the World Cup, hosted with relish by Qatar, the event seemed so close to home. The new edition of the World Cup is far away, across multiple time zones.

At a time when sports bodies around the globe come in for flak for being overly commercial, football is no exception. There is an excess of club football taking place across the world. Nobody minds it, as there is viewership for each such event. Who would have thought CR7, considered past his prime, would move away from Europe and ply his trade in a rich league in Saudi Arabia? That Cristiano Ronaldo now lives like a rich Sheikh in a palatial mansion in the desert is well known.

Back to the World Cup, for a record sixth time, Ronaldo will be representing Portugal. They are certainly not a side featured among the favourites by the bookmakers. For sure, the legend of CR7 will be on view. At 41, he is trying to tell the world that age is just a number. In terms of fitness, speed and agility, he still looks good while playing club football in Saudi Arabia. The World Cup, however, will be very different and far more challenging.

To think that Ronaldo plays for personal milestones alone is wrong. When Portugal fared poorly in the last World Cup, fans thought they had seen CR7 for the last time. He has ensured that he remains relevant and

continues to play for Portugal, a nation that once had famous names who evoked awe and excitement. Portugal in the 2026 World Cup is certainly not a heavyweight.

If Ronaldo is there for the romantics who have admired him for such a long time, Lionel Messi, who turns 39 on June 27, is still a major force. Football is a demanding sport in many ways. Speed, skill and cunning — Messi still possesses them all and continues to play free-flowing football as he leads the campaign of defending champions Argentina. Those who love the South American flavour will still back Argentina passionately. However, even teams that are not heavily hyped can do well.

The 48-team format for the World Cup is massive. If some think the size is unwieldy, the custodians of world football disagree. There is a common feeling that there is no reason to limit the draw. At the same time, more teams mean more matches, which is good news for television. Football is about sponsorship, massive broadcast rights and how the sport is sold for megabucks.

Given the size of FIFA's membership, which stands at 211, there is no equitable distribution. Europe contributes 55 members, Africa 54, North America, Central America and the Caribbean 41, Asia 47, Oceania 11, and South America 11. Out of these, if 48 teams are in the World Cup proper, it means increased representation in the biggest sporting event in the world.

For those who follow football, the World Cup comes next to, or just behind, the Summer

FACES TO WATCH

Lionel Messi, Cristiano Ronaldo, Erling Haaland, Vinicius Junior, Mohamed Salah, Lamine Yamal, Arda Guler, Nico Paz and Luka Vuskovic.





MADE IN INDIA: A TITAN STORY

Before it sat on millions of wrists, it was just an idea

Featuring Naseeruddin Shah as JRD Tata and Jim Sarbh as Xerxes Desai, the series revisits a transformative chapter in India's entrepreneurial journey



OUR CORRESPONDENT

The time has finally come to witness a legacy unfold. 'Amazon MX Player' brings to screen 'Made in India: A Titan Story', a compelling period drama that chronicles the extraordinary rise of 'Titan' watches, one of India's most iconic consumer brands. Featuring Naseeruddin Shah as JRD Tata and Jim Sarbh as Xerxes Desai, the series revisits a transformative chapter in India's entrepreneurial journey, where vision, resilience and innovation converged to build a legacy that continues to define Indian excellence. Directed by Robbie Grewal and under the banner of 'Almighty Motion Pictures', the series transforms a landmark business success story into an engrossing drama about ambition, belief and the courage to create something the world had never seen before.

Here are four reasons why 'Made in India: A Titan Story' deserves our time:

ACTING THAT TRANSCENDS THE SCREEN

At the heart of the series lies

a cast that doesn't merely portray characters but inhabits them with remarkable depth. Naseeruddin Shah brings remarkable poise and wisdom to the role of JRD Tata, embodying a leader whose influence stemmed from vision and conviction. Jim Sarbh delivers one of his most nuanced performances as Xerxes Desai, capturing the relentless drive, creativity and determination of a man who dared to challenge convention. Together, they create a dynamic that feels less like performance and more like witnessing history take form. Supporting actors, including Vaibhav Tatwawadi, Namita Dubey, Lakshvir Saran and Kaveri Seth, add emotional depth and authenticity, ensuring every character contributes meaningfully to the larger story of Titan's rise.

A SOUNDSCAPE THAT ECHOES THE SPIRIT OF ITS TIME

From light-hearted retro melodies to emotionally resonant moments, the music in 'Made in India: A Titan Story' does more than accompany the narrative; it enriches it. Capturing the mood, ambition and energy of India on the

AT THE HEART OF THE SERIES LIES A CAST THAT DOESN'T merely portray CHARACTERS BUT INHABITS THEM WITH REMARKABLE DEPTH

cus of change, the soundtrack adds an unmistakable sense of place and period to the storytelling.

A REMARKABLE RESEMBLANCE TO REALITY

One of the most striking creative choices lies in how the series bridges fiction and memory. The uncanny resemblance of Naseeruddin Shah as JRD Tata and Jim Sarbh as Xerxes Desai becomes more than casting; it becomes immersion. This is further heightened by the seamless integration of archival photographs and

period visuals, which surface within scenes like fragments of memory. The result is a layered viewing experience where storytelling gently folds into history and history, in turn, feels startlingly present.

THE MAKING OF 'TITAN'

Beyond its emotional arc, the series carefully unpacks the intricate process of building something unprecedented in India at the time. From early uncertainties to structural decisions and bold experimentation in an uncharted category like watches, every layer reflects a world still learning how to build at scale. It quietly captures the Tata philosophy of discipline, precision and long-term vision, where every role, every decision and every setback becomes part of a larger architecture of trust and ambition.

'MADE IN INDIA

'A Titan Story' is powered by cinematic ambition, offering a premium viewing experience with no subscription barrier. With its layered storytelling, evocative performances and rich world-building, it goes beyond a retelling, becoming an immersive journey of how ideas evolve into institutions and legacies take shape.

SYSTEM

A STORY OF POWER, PRIVILEGE & JUSTICE

Courtroom dramas have long explored the ideas of power and justice, but this film goes much beyond the familiar binaries of right and wrong

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Courtroom dramas have long explored the ideas of power and justice, but Prime Video's 'System' goes much beyond the familiar binaries of right and wrong. In addition to the case that forms its crux, the film has sparked conversation for bringing together three formidable women to tell a story where power is shaped by perspective and justice is never quite as clear as it first appears. At the heart of this story are Sonakshi Sinha, Jyotika and creator-director Ashwini Iyer Tiwari, who tap into this genre not merely to examine justice, but to delve deeper into how power is experienced, negotiated and understood through a distinctly female lens.

Sonakshi's Neha Rajvansh, a public prosecutor, enters the story with privilege, influence and the weight of legacy. Jyotika's Sarika Rawat, a courtroom stenographer, comes from a completely different and much humbler world, but understands the system in ways that are far sharper than people around her realise. Much of the conversation around the film is centred on this very contrast and for good reason.

For Sonakshi, the role marks another addition to a growing body of work based on women operating within systems of authority. After projects like 'Dahaad', she once again steps



into a space traditionally dominated by male protagonists. Yet Neha Rajvansh is far from an uncomplicated figure. The character's confidence is rooted in access and opportunity, but the film steadily peels back those layers, forcing her to confront uncomfortable truths about merit, perception and accountability. Jyotika becomes the film's emotional compass, bringing remarkable conviction and restraint to Sarika's journey. And as the story moves forward, it becomes clear that her true battle extends far beyond the walls of the courtroom.

Behind both these phenomenal performances is Ashwini's understanding of the world the film inhabits. Her idea of privilege runs far deeper than money. As she puts it, "Privilege has a huge meaning. I don't think privilege is quantified by the amount of money you have in your bank." In 'System', that idea plays out in the ways power is shaped by access, perception,

class and the room people are allowed to occupy.

Jyotika's link with the film comes through just as clearly in the way Sarika is written and portrayed. For her, the appeal of the project lies in how it looks at women without sanding off their edges. Jyotika summarises it perfectly as she says, "I've always believed that women should be shown on screen as they are in real life, strong, resilient, composed, aggressive - everything that they are in real life. We often divert from that and portray them in different ways to suit the male gaze." And that instinct fits Sarika really well. She is guarded, layered and not easily penetrated, which gives Jyotika space to let silence do a great deal of the work.

Ashwini's own approach to female-driven stories also finds a natural home in 'System'. She has reflected on how wary the industry often becomes of morally grey women and stories that are allowed to breathe at their own

pace, noting, "We become so wary of telling stories of women, of telling stories of morally grey women, of telling stories that take their time to breathe and they are not cut like rails." That sensibility runs through the film, which resists neat answers and instead lets its women remain complicated, self-aware and very much human.

Perhaps that is also why the film appears to have stayed with everyone associated with it long after production wrapped. Reflecting on the journey in a heartfelt note following its release, she wrote, "We always made sure that we cared for each other enough to know that making 'system' is not just a movie that will pass by. It's a part of us for life. It shows in the tiny details only for us to know and rejoice and if you see it's because there are multiple heartbeats singing the same tune. Yes, this movie sets you thinking, makes you uncomfortable and grows on you long after you have watched it, until the next story to be told. Cinema is for life. It's beyond my lifetime. Forever Gratitude. 'SYSTEM' - A movie I am very proud of is now on 'Prime Video' and will have its own journey of love and reflection."

Ultimately, 'System' isn't really about deciding who's right and who's wrong. It's about two incredible women who understand power in very different ways and move through it with their own logic, bruises and convictions.

THE BIOMECHANICS BEHIND SOORYAVANSHI'S BRILLIANCE

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's phenomenal rise has left former Pakistani cricketers and experts in awe

ASIF ULLAH KHAN

Dr Nauman Niaz, a well-known Pakistani cricket broadcaster and analyst, is, by profession, an internal medicine specialist, endocrinologist and diabetologist. Yet, over the years, he has become just as famous in the cricketing world for his deep and often unconventional analysis of the game. He co-hosts the 'YouTube' show 'Caught Behind' with former Pakistan captain Rashid Latif. What sets Dr Niaz apart from most television pundits is his tendency to bring medical science, physiology and biomechanics into discussions that others view purely through a cricketing lens.

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's phenomenal rise has left former Pakistani cricketers and experts in awe. The teenage sensation has not only announced his arrival on the cricketing stage, but has also dominated opponents through a combination of fearlessness, timing and extraordinary power that seems beyond his years.

Dr Niaz offered a fascinating explanation for Sooryavanshi's success. According to him, what cricket fans are witnessing is not merely exceptional talent but a rare combination of biomechanics, neuromuscular development, genetics and years of highly specialised training. The way Sooryavanshi hits sixes, Dr Niaz argued, should not be possible for a boy who is only 15 years old.

For Dr Niaz, the explanation begins with what he calls a 'genetic gift'. While he does not attribute Sooryavanshi's success entirely to genetics, he believes the youngster possesses natural physical advantages that are difficult to teach. The remarkable coordination between his eyes, brain and body, combined with unusual balance and power generation, suggests an athlete blessed with exceptional raw material.

One of the most important factors, according to Dr Niaz, is Sooryavanshi's ability to pick the length of the ball unusually early. Years of repetition since childhood have created powerful muscle memory, allowing him to process visual information and react faster than most batters. Those extra fractions of a second give him enough time to position himself correctly and execute strokes with devastating effect.

Dr Niaz is particularly fascinated by Sooryavanshi's body mechanics. He argues that the teenager employs movement patterns more commonly associated with elite baseball hitters than traditional cricketers. The batter coils his body before impact, creating separation between his hips and shoulders. This separation stores rotational energy, which is then released through the bat at the moment of contact. In sports science, this is known as the kinetic chain - the efficient transfer of energy from the ground through the legs, hips, torso, shoulders and arms.

The result is extraordinary power generation. According to Dr Niaz, Sooryavanshi does not rely solely on muscular strength. Instead, he maximises torque, balance and rotational force. His lower body acts as a stable platform while his upper body releases energy like a compressed spring. This, Dr Niaz believes, explains how a 15-year-old can clear boundaries with the authority normally associated with fully developed international cricketers.

Another aspect that impressed Dr Niaz is what he describes as Sooryavanshi's dynamic balance. Even while attempting aggressive strokes, the youngster remains



While he does not attribute Sooryavanshi's success entirely to genetics, he believes the youngster possesses natural physical advantages that are difficult to teach

remarkably stable. His strong back leg absorbs force efficiently, while his centre of gravity stays controlled throughout the shot. Such a balance allows him to generate power without sacrificing consistency.

On the psychological side of performance, Dr Niaz believes Sooryavanshi's confidence stems from mastery rather than bravado. Because he reads length early and consistently finds the middle of the bat, he approaches bowlers with genuine self-belief. For a player barely in his mid-teens, his composure appears strikingly mature.

Perhaps the most intriguing part of Dr Niaz's assessment is his warning against overcorrecting the youngster's physique in the pursuit of modern fitness standards. He argues that coaches should be careful not to alter the very body mechanics that make Sooryavanshi special. Fitness, fielding and athletic conditioning can be improved, but the rotational efficiency, flexibility and power-production system already present in his game should be preserved rather than rebuilt.

For Dr Niaz, Sooryavanshi is not merely a T20 hitter or a fleeting teenage sensation. The biomechanical qualities he identifies - early ball recognition, balance, rotational power, adaptability and neuromuscular efficiency - are traits that translate across formats. In his view, they are the foundations of a complete batter rather than a limited power hitter.

Whether Sooryavanshi ultimately fulfils the enormous expectations surrounding him remains to be seen. But if Dr Niaz's analysis is correct, cricket fans may be witnessing something far rarer than a gifted teenager. They are watching the emergence of an athlete whose body, mind and technique have combined to create one of the most fascinating batting talents of his generation.

